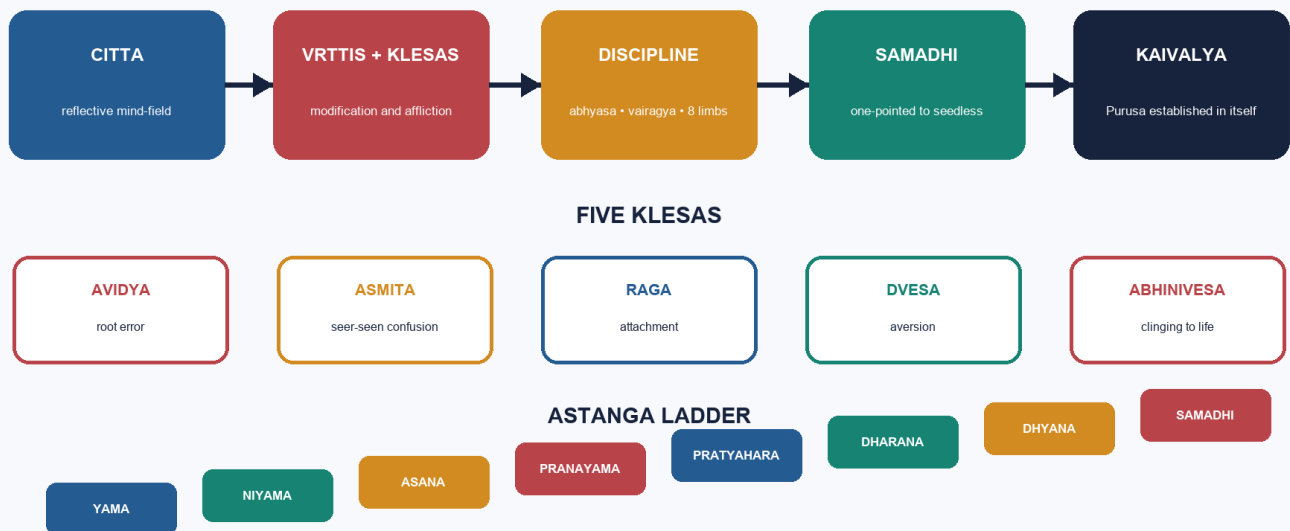


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

YOGA - Layered Complete Learning Session - Syllabus Item 17

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

PATANJALA YOGA: FROM CITTA-VRTTI TO KAIVALYA



Isvara = purusa-visesa and privileged aid; viveka-khyati, not divine fusion, completes liberation.

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

YOGA - Layered Complete Learning Session - Syllabus Item 17

Syllabus (verbatim): Yoga; Citta; Cittavṛtti; Klesas; Samadhi; Kaivalya. **Evidence key:** FACT: canonical doctrine · ANALYSIS: analytical synthesis · CAUTION: contested **Placement:** Yoga is the practical-soteriological counterpart of Sāṃkhya in Paper I Indian philosophy. UPSC repeatedly asks citta, citta-vṛtti-nirodha, kleśa-removal, samādhi, kaivalya and the distinct place of Īśvara in **śeśvara-sāṃkhya**.

How to use this layered session

Every logical subtopic follows the Philosophy five-layer sequence:

Layer	Purpose
1. SIMPLE START	Plain-language visual gateway
2. CORE UPSC	Complete retained doctrine, terminology, arguments and examples
3. ADVANCED	Objections, replies, comparisons and qualified evaluation
4. EXAM APPLICATION	Verified PYQ routing and marks-wise answer structure
5. RAPID REVISION	Traps, recall spines and mastery preparation

Source audit: the canonical Yoga knowledge file and complete 2018-2025 Indian Philosophy PYQ bank were checked. The source session's direct OCR anchors to Chatterjee-Datta and C. D. Sharma are retained. The official 2026 International Day of Yoga theme and Ministry of Ayush context were rechecked and are used only as a contemporary public-health anchor, not as evidence for Patanjala metaphysics. Qdrant was not required.

Preservation note: every substantive section of the earlier complete session is retained. The new material adds simple visual gateways and explicit learning layers without replacing or compressing the original depth.

Progress: 1 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Yoga as Sesvara-Samkhya and the Structure of Citta

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - the mind is the instrument, not the self

OBJECTS -> SENSES -> CITTA
|
manas + ahamkara + buddhi
|
reflects PURUSA's light
|
"I am thinking and suffering"

Yoga disciplines citta so witness and instrument are no longer confused.

In simple words: Yoga accepts Samkhya's Purusa-Prakriti dualism but develops a detailed practical psychology. Citta is the subtle material mind-complex; Purusa is the conscious witness.

Citta condition	Easy meaning
Ksipta	Restless
Mudha	Dull
Vikṣipta	Sometimes focused
Ekagra	One-pointed
Niruddha	Fully restrained

Memory line: Samkhya gives the map; Yoga trains the mind that misreads the map.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

0. ONE-SCREEN MAP

YOGA = sāmkhya-pravacana + Īśvara + disciplined soteriology
|
Metaphysical base: 25 tattvas shared with Sāmkhya
|
Practical field: citta (mind-complex) becomes coloured by objects and reflects puruṣa
|
Problem: cittavṛttis + kleśas → karma → vipāka → āśaya → punarjanma
|
Method: abhyāsa + vairāgya; kriyā-yoga; aṣṭāṅga-yoga; Īśvara-praṇidhāna
|
Culmination: samādhi → viveka-khyāti → para-vairāgya → dharmamegha-samādhi
|
End: kaivalya = isolation/aloneness of puruṣa from prakṛti

ANALYSIS: Exam key: Yoga is not merely posture-discipline. It is a full theory of mind, bondage, meditative cognition and liberation built on Sāmkhya ontology but modified by the admission of **Īśvara** as **puruṣa-viśeṣa**.

INTRODUCTION — YOGA AS SEŚVARA-SĀMĀKHYA

- FACT: Classical Yoga is often described as **sāmkhya-pravacana** or **seśvara-sāmkhya**: it shares the metaphysical structure of Sāmkhya but adds a practical path and a theistic element.
- FACT: It accepts the basic dualism of **puruṣa** and **prakṛti**, and the standard **25 tattvas** of Sāmkhya.
- FACT: What Yoga adds is a carefully graded **soteriology**: control of citta, attenuation of kleśas, meditative absorption, and final kaivalya.
- FACT: It also admits **Īśvara**, a **special puruṣa** untouched by affliction and karmic residue, thereby distinguishing itself from nirīśvara Sāmkhya.
- ANALYSIS: Thus the school may be summed up as: **Sāmkhya gives the metaphysical map; Yoga gives the psychology and method of release.**
- ANALYSIS: In UPSC answers, this introductory framing immediately prevents two confusions: Yoga is neither merely physical culture nor an Advaitic path of union with Brahman.

1. CITTA

1.1 Statement

- FACT: **Citta** (citta) is the internal organ or mind-complex through which cognition, affect, volition and meditative discipline become possible.
- FACT: In Yoga, citta is not merely **manas** in isolation; it functions as the unified internal apparatus comprising **buddhi**, **ahaṁkāra** and **manas**.
- FACT: Its material basis is from prakṛti and, more specifically, from the **sāttvika** aspect of **ahaṁkāra** in the Sāmkhyan evolutionary scheme.
- ANALYSIS: Therefore citta is best understood as **the psychological instrument of experience**, not as the true self.

1.2 Constitution of citta

Component within the functioning unity of citta	Primary role	Why Yoga includes it under citta
Buddhi	determinative intellect, ascertainment	decisive cognition, discrimination, resolve occur here
Ahaṁkāra	ego-principle, appropriation as "I"	ownership of states, doership and identification arise here
Manas	sensory co-ordination, doubt, oscillation	receives and arranges sense-data, moves between options

- FACT: Though Sāṃkhya analytically distinguishes these, Yoga often treats them as one operative continuum called **citta**.
- ANALYSIS: This broad usage is philosophically useful because bondage and liberation both concern the **whole mental field**, not one isolated faculty.

1.3 Citta as reflective, not self-luminous in its own right

- FACT: Citta is a product of prakṛti and therefore **insentient** in itself.
- FACT: Yet because of its subtle, sāttvika transparency, it can **reflect** consciousness.
- FACT: The standard analogy is that of a **clear crystal placed near a flower**: the crystal appears coloured by the flower though it is itself colourless.
- FACT: Similarly, citta takes on the form and colour of objects placed before it, while the consciousness of **puruṣa** is reflected in it.
- ANALYSIS: The empirical self arises when the reflected consciousness in citta is mistaken for the intrinsic nature of citta itself.
- ANALYSIS: Hence Yoga's theory of mind is neither crude materialism nor idealism: citta is material-subtle, but consciousness belongs originally to puruṣa.

1.4 Misidentification of self with citta

- FACT: So long as citta is modified by objects, memories, desires, fears and conceptual constructions, the self appears entangled in them.
- FACT: The reflective relation causes bondage when **discriminative knowledge** is absent.
- FACT: A standard exam-worthy formulation is: **so long as there are changes and modifications in citta, the self is reflected therein and, lacking discriminative discernment, identifies itself with those modifications.**
- ANALYSIS: This is the psychological core of bondage in Yoga: the seer is confused with the seen because reflection masquerades as identity.

1.4A Reflection (pratibimba/chāyā) presuppositions

Statement. FACT: Yoga's reflection theory says that **citta** appears conscious because it stands near **puruṣa**, while puruṣa appears bound because its light is reflected in citta; this is a **pratibimba** (pratibimba; reflection) or **chāyā** (chaya; shadow-image) model, not a literal alteration of puruṣa.

Argument.

1. FACT: **Puruṣa** is **apariṇāmin** (aparinamin; unchanging) and therefore cannot literally act, suffer, acquire qualities or undergo modification.
2. FACT: **Citta** is a product of **prakṛti** and is therefore **jaḍa** (jaḍa; insentient), yet its sattva-predominance makes it transparent, subtle and capable of mirroring.
3. FACT: Since an inactive consciousness cannot enter causal contact like one physical object striking another, knowledge requires a reflection/proximity model rather than a crude causal-contact model.
4. FACT: Bondage is therefore the confusion of **asmitā** and **sva-svāmi-śakti** (sva-svami-shakti; the power of the owned and the owner): citta's borrowed consciousness is misread as selfhood, and puruṣa's witnesshood is misread as agency.

5. ANALYSIS: The soteriological task is not to change puruṣa but to end the cognitive misattribution by purifying and restraining citta.

Presupposition. FACT: The model presupposes the Sāṃkhya-Yoga dualism of two irreducible orders: conscious but inactive puruṣa, and active but insentient prakṛti/citta.

Example. FACT: The crystal (**sphaṭika**) near a red flower seems red without itself becoming the flower; ANALYSIS: similarly, a magnet and iron image helps exam writing: mere presence (**sannidhi**) can explain movement on the iron/citta side without action on the magnet/puruṣa side.

Objection. ANALYSIS: A reflection normally requires some real relation between mirror and original. If puruṣa and prakṛti are ontologically disjoint, how can inactive puruṣa be "reflected" in citta at all?

Reply. FACT: Yoga replies through **sannidhi-mātra** (sannidhi-matra; mere proximity): the transformation is entirely on the citta side; puruṣa neither acts nor changes. ANALYSIS: Yet the objection retains residual force, because Advaita and Nyāya can press the classic problem of how two radically different principles can explain one experience.

1.5 Why citta matters for soteriology

- FACT: Since bondage occurs through citta, liberation must also be worked out through citta.
- FACT: One does not destroy puruṣa's bondage by changing puruṣa itself, because puruṣa is eternally pure.
- FACT: Rather, one disciplines citta so completely that the false identification ceases.
- ANALYSIS: Yoga is therefore fundamentally a **therapy of attention, habit, impression and misidentification**.

1.6 Citta-bhūmis — the five levels or conditions of citta

- FACT: Yoga tradition classifies citta into **five bhūmis** or operative levels.
- FACT: These levels indicate the dominance of the guṇas and the fitness of the mind for yoga.

Citta-bhūmi	Dominant guṇa-pattern	Basic character	Exam use
Kṣipta (ksipta)	rajas dominant	restless, scattered, thrown outward	ordinary agitated mind
Mūḍha (mudha)	tamas dominant	dull, torpid, stupefied	lethargic, clouded mind
Vikṣipta (viksīpta)	mixed, with occasional sattva	intermittently focused but unstable	capable in bursts, still worldly
Ekāgra (ekagra)	sattva dominant	one-pointed, concentrated	fit for true yogic practice
Niruddha (niruddha)	vṛttis restrained	all modifications arrested	culmination of yogic discipline

1.7 Explanation of the five bhūmis

(a) Kṣipta

- FACT: The mind runs from object to object under rajasic impulsion.
- FACT: There is activity, but not integration.
- ANALYSIS: Desire, worry, ambition and sensory dispersion dominate.

(b) Mūḍha

- FACT: The mind is overpowered by tamas.
- FACT: Torpor, delusion, inertia and confusion prevail.
- ANALYSIS: This state is not calmness but obscurity.

(c) Vikṣipta

- FACT: The mind can attend, infer, analyse and even sustain brief concentration, but cannot remain inwardly collected.
- FACT: Sattva flashes forth occasionally, yet rajas and tamas are not overcome.
- ANALYSIS: This is the condition of many intelligent worldly persons: capable of focus, but not yet spiritually integrated.

(d) Ekāgra

- FACT: The mind becomes one-pointed on a chosen support.
- FACT: Sattva predominates sufficiently for meditative absorption to deepen.
- FACT: This is one of the two genuinely yoga-fit states.

(e) Niruddha

- FACT: The modifications are fully restrained.
- FACT: This is not unconscious blankness but the consummation of disciplined inwardness.
- FACT: It is the citta-state correlated with the highest samādhi and the approach to kaivalya.

1.8 Which citta-bhūmis are fit for yoga?

- FACT: Only **ekāgra** and **niruddha** are fully fit for authentic yoga.
- FACT: **Kṣipta**, **mūḍha** and **vikṣipta** remain pre-yogic or only partially prepared stages.
- ANALYSIS: The transition from vikṣipta to ekāgra is decisive: the mind moves from occasional concentration to sustained one-pointedness.

1.9 PYQ application: scientist, devotee, self-realized yogi

- FACT: UPSC in 2019 used the citta-bhūmi classification in applied form.
- FACT: A **scientist** intensely focused on an empirical problem yet still directed outward and attached to worldly ends is best classified as **vikṣipta**.
- FACT: A **God-realized devotee** whose mind is one-pointedly centred upon Īśvara is **ekāgra**.
- FACT: A **self-realized yogi** in whom all modifications are fully stilled is **niruddha**.
- ANALYSIS: The subtlety is important: high intellectual focus does not itself amount to yogic restraint.

1.10 Citta in inter-school perspective

School	What is the internal organ?	Key contrast with Yoga
Sāṃkhya	buddhi, ahaṃkāra, manas analytically distinct	Yoga gathers them functionally as citta
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	manas as atomic internal sense	Yoga's citta is far broader than atomic manas
Vedānta	antaḥkaraṇa under avidyā, with Brahman framework	Yoga retains plural puruṣas and no Brahman-doctrine

1.11 Mini-conclusion on citta

- ANALYSIS: For UPSC, define citta as the **sāttvika psychical instrument composed of buddhi-ahaṃkāra-manas, reflecting puruṣa and becoming modified by objects**.
- ANALYSIS: Then show why Yoga insists on discipline: without citta-niyama, puruṣa continues to identify with borrowed mental states.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced reflection problem

Citta unifies buddhi, ahaṃkāra and manas as one operative field. It is materially subtle and sattva-dominant, so it can reflect consciousness while remaining insentient in itself. Bondage occurs when borrowed luminosity is mistaken for intrinsic selfhood.

The reflection model protects an unchanging Puruṣa: every transformation occurs on the citta side. Yet it presupposes an intelligible relation between radically different orders. Mere proximity avoids physical interaction but does not completely explain how one experience contains both object-form and witnesshood.

The citta-bhūmi scheme is soteriological rather than a generic intelligence scale. A scientist may display powerful but outward and intermittent focus, while only ekāgra and niruddha are fully suited to liberating Yoga.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- **2019 Q7(b)**: classify scientist as viksipta, God-centred devotee as ekagra and self-realized yogi as niruddha, with justification.
- Define citta as buddhi-ahamkara-manas functioning together.
- State that citta is not self-luminous and Purusa does not literally change.
- Open broad answers with Yoga as **Sesvara-Samkhya plus disciplined soteriology**.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Yoga shares Samkhya's 25 tattvas and dualism.
- Citta is material-subtle; Purusa is conscious.
- Reflection explains empirical cognition and misidentification.
- Yoga-fit states: ekagra and niruddha.
- Trap: high intellectual concentration alone is not final yogic restraint.

Progress: 2 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Cittavrtti-Nirodha: Five Modifications and Real Transformation of Mind

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - why even true thoughts are waves

CITTA takes the form of:

true knowledge | error | word-construction | sleep | memory
|
PURUSA identifies
|
bondage

ABHYASA + VAIRAGYA -> increasingly stable restraint

In simple words: Yoga does not say every thought is false. It says every thought is a changing form of citta. True cognition can help liberation, but final freedom requires ending identification with all mental forms.

Vrtti	Simple meaning
Pramana	Valid cognition
Viparyaya	Error
Vikalpa	Words without corresponding object
Nidra	Sleep-mode
Smrti	Memory

Memory line: truth can be a ladder, but the witness is not the ladder.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

2. CITTAVṚTTI

2.1 Statement

- FACT: **Cittavṛtti** (cittavṛtti) means a modification, fluctuation or operative mode of citta.
- FACT: Yoga holds that citta constantly assumes forms corresponding to objects, memories, errors, absences and verbal constructions.
- FACT: These modifications are the immediate field of bondage because the reflected self falsely identifies with them.

2.2 Foundational sūtra

- FACT: The defining statement of the system is: "**Yogaś-citta-vṛtti-nirodhaḥ**" — Yoga is the restraint of the modifications of citta.
- FACT: The immediately following implication is: "**tadā draṣṭuḥ svarūpe'vasthānam**" — then the seer abides in its own nature.
- ANALYSIS: These two aphorisms together explain the entire logic of Yoga: control is not an end in itself; it is required because only when vṛttis cease does puruṣa stand free of misidentification.

2.3 Why is cessation prescribed?

1. FACT: Citta, by its nature, takes the form of whatever it attends to.
 2. FACT: Puruṣa's consciousness is reflected in citta.
 3. FACT: In ignorance, the self appropriates these changing forms as "I know," "I suffer," "I desire," "I remember."
 4. FACT: Therefore the stream of vṛttis sustains bondage.
 5. FACT: Their restraint uncovers the already-free nature of the seer.
- ANALYSIS: A safe image is the clear pool: when ripples settle, the water reflects without distortion; when cittavṛttis settle, puruṣa is no longer misread through mental turbulence.
 - ANALYSIS: Thus **nirodha** is revelatory, not destructive: it removes concealment, not consciousness.

2.4 The five vṛttis

- FACT: Patañjali classifies all modifications into **five kinds**.
- FACT: Each may be either **kliṣṭa** or **akliṣṭa** depending on whether it sustains affliction or aids release.

Vṛtti	Definition	Example	Philosophical note
Pramāṇa	valid cognition	seeing smoke and correctly inferring fire	even true knowledge is still a modification
Viparyaya	error or misconception	taking nacre for silver	false cognition distorts conduct
Vikalpa	verbal or conceptual construction without real object	"the horn of a hare"	language can move without ontic referent
Nidrā	sleep as a positive mental mode grounded in absence-content	awareness later reported as "I slept"	even sleep is not non-mental blankness
Smṛti	memory	recollection of past pain or pleasure	retained traces re-present prior experience

2.5 Pramāṇa as vṛtti

- FACT: Yoga does not deny valid cognition; it includes it as one kind of vṛtti.
- FACT: The accepted forms of pramāṇa are **pratyakṣa** (perception), **anumāna** (inference) and **āgama/śabda** (authoritative testimony).
- FACT: This aligns Yoga with the three-pramāṇa scheme of Sāṃkhya.
- ANALYSIS: Exam point: because even valid cognition is still a citta-modification, Yoga seeks not endless conceptual accumulation but eventual stilling.
- ANALYSIS: Cross-reference: see Pramāṇa across schools.

2.6 Viparyaya

- FACT: **Viparyaya** is false knowledge not corresponding to the object as it is.
- FACT: It includes perceptual and conceptual misapprehension.
- ANALYSIS: Since error reinforces wrong attachment and aversion, it is typically **kliṣṭa**.

2.7 Vikalpa

- FACT: **Vikalpa** is cognition produced by words alone where no corresponding object exists.
- FACT: It is not sheer nonsense; it has linguistic intelligibility without objective referent.
- ANALYSIS: Yoga is sensitive to the autonomous power of language to create mental worlds, anxieties, dogmas and imagined identities.

2.8 Nidrā

- FACT: Sleep is treated as a positive vṛtti rather than a mere absence.
- FACT: Later recollection — "I slept and knew nothing" — shows that sleep leaves a determinate mental trace.
- ANALYSIS: Philosophically, Yoga refuses to equate quiescence with liberation: mere sleep suppresses activity, but does not produce discriminative freedom.

2.9 Smṛti

- FACT: Memory is the re-presentation of past experience without complete loss of its prior content.
- FACT: Smṛti links past impressions to present identity and reaction.
- ANALYSIS: In practical psychology, memory feeds attachment, trauma, fear and habitual self-narration.

2.10 Kliṣṭa and akliṣṭa vṛttis

- FACT: Each of the five vṛttis can be either **kliṣṭa** (afflicted) or **akliṣṭa** (non-afflicted).
- FACT: **Kliṣṭa vṛttis** are those coloured by avidyā and the other kleśas and hence productive of bondage.
- FACT: **Akliṣṭa vṛttis** are those purified and redirected toward discrimination, detachment and liberation.
- ANALYSIS: For example, valid cognition of impermanence, disciplined scriptural reflection or recollection aiding practice may be akliṣṭa, while the same broad vṛtti-types in service of vanity or desire remain kliṣṭa.

2.11 Why this distinction matters

- FACT: Yoga does not begin by abolishing all cognition at once.
- FACT: It first transforms the quality of mental life, replacing afflicted modifications by non-afflicted ones.
- ANALYSIS: Akliṣṭa vṛttis are therapeutic instruments that ultimately subside once their work is done.

2.12 Means of citta-vṛtti-nirodha

- FACT: The basic means are **abhyāsa** (sustained practice) and **vairāgya** (detachment).
- FACT: Kriyā-yoga weakens afflictive forces.
- FACT: Aṣṭāṅga-yoga progressively disciplines the body-sense-mind complex.
- FACT: Īśvara-praṇidhāna offers a theistic aid to concentration and obstacle-removal.
- ANALYSIS: Thus nirodha is methodical, not abrupt.

2.13 Cittavṛtti and the 2023 demand

- FACT: The 2023 question asked both **what citta and its modifications are** and **why cessation is prescribed**.
- ANALYSIS: The ideal answer must therefore move in three steps: define citta, list the five vṛttis, and explain nirodha through the misidentification of puruṣa with citta.

2.14 Cittavṛtti and the 2024 demand

- FACT: The 2024 wording emphasized that as long as citta changes, the self is reflected therein and identifies itself with those changes in the absence of discriminative knowledge.
- ANALYSIS: This directly joins §1 and §2: the question is not about mental mechanics alone but about Yoga's full **soteriology of reflection, confusion and restraint**.

2.15 Mini-conclusion on cittavṛtti

- ANALYSIS: In exam language: **cittavṛttis are the dynamic forms assumed by the mind-complex; they must be restrained because their ongoing operation sustains the false identification of the seer with the seen.**

2.16 Citta-pariṇāma — transformation of the mental substrate

Statement. FACT: **Citta-pariṇāma** (citta-parinama; transformation of citta) is Yoga's account of how the mind-complex really changes across practice without destroying its continuity as a prakṛtic substrate.

Argument.

1. FACT: The Vibhūti-pāda tradition recognises three specifically yogic transformations of citta: **nirodha-pariṇāma**, **samādhi-pariṇāma** and **ekāgratā-pariṇāma**.
2. FACT: **Nirodha-pariṇāma** is the transformation in which impressions of restraint increasingly overpower impressions of emergence; the mind becomes habituated to cessation rather than dispersion.
3. FACT: **Samādhi-pariṇāma** is the transformation from many-pointedness to unified absorption; the distracting multiplicity of contents weakens while one object becomes dominant.
4. FACT: **Ekāgratā-pariṇāma** is the transformation of one-pointed continuity, where similar cognitive moments arise and subside in an unbroken stream toward the same object.
5. FACT: Yoga also accepts a general threefold transformation of any substrate: **dharma-pariṇāma** (dharma-parinama; change of property), **lakṣaṇa-pariṇāma** (laksana-parinama; change of temporal character) and **avasthā-pariṇāma** (avastha-parinama; change of condition or state).
6. FACT: These transformations presuppose a **dharmin** (dharmin; persisting substrate) that undergoes changes of property, temporal phase and condition without becoming sheer momentary flashes.
7. ANALYSIS: This is philosophically necessary because Yoga inherits Sāṃkhya **pariṇāmavāda** (parinamavada; real transformation): citta really changes, and the path's graded progress would be unintelligible if there were no continuing mental substrate.

Presupposition. FACT: The doctrine presupposes that prakṛti and its evolutes are real and transformable, while puruṣa remains unmodified witness-consciousness.

Example. ANALYSIS: The same lake can be stormy, gradually calming, and finally still; the states differ, yet the lake-substrate persists. Likewise citta can pass from kṣipta to ekāgra to niruddha without becoming a new self.

Objection. ANALYSIS: A Buddhist **kṣaṇikavādin** (ksanikavadin; momentarist) may argue that only a stream of momentary events is needed; a persisting citta-substrate is an unnecessary fiction.

Reply. FACT: Yoga answers that practice, memory, saṃskāra-continuity and stable meditative acquisition require more than disconnected flashes. ANALYSIS: Both Yoga and Buddhism admit ceaseless change, but Yoga retains a persisting prakṛtic substrate, whereas Buddhist **kṣaṇikavāda** (ksanikavada; momentariness) denies enduring mental substance.

Comparison	Yoga's position	Exam contrast
FACT: Yoga's pariṇāma vs Buddhist kṣaṇikavāda	FACT: Real change occurs in a continuing citta/dharmin.	ANALYSIS: Buddhism can explain flow without a substrate; Yoga needs substrate for saṃskāra and graded discipline.
FACT: Yoga's pariṇāma vs Advaita vivartavāda (vivartavada; apparent transformation)	FACT: Change in citta/prakṛti is real, not merely apparent.	ANALYSIS: Advaita makes ultimate reality non-transforming Brahman; Yoga keeps real prakṛtic change and many puruṣas.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced transformation and continuity

Vṛttis may be afflicted or non-afflicted. Yoga therefore proceeds therapeutically: aklista cognition and disciplined memory replace afflicted patterns before all object-identification subsides. Nirodha is revelatory restraint, not violent destruction or unconscious blankness.

Citta-parinama supplies a realist account of progress. Nirodha-parinama strengthens impressions of restraint; samadhi-parinama shifts from many-pointedness to absorption; ekagrata-parinama stabilizes one-pointed continuity. These changes presuppose a persisting prakṛtic substrate rather than momentary flashes.

Buddhist momentariness can explain habits through causal series, but Yoga argues that a continuing citta better bears saṃskaras and graded transformation. The dispute concerns whether continuity requires a substrate or only a stream.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- **2023 Q7(c):** define citta, list five vṛttis and derive why nirodha is necessary.
- **2024 Q7(b):** connect changing citta, reflected consciousness, absent discrimination and Yoga's whole soteriology.
- Explain why pramana may be aklista yet remains a vṛtti.
- Distinguish nidra from disciplined cessation and asamprajnata samadhi.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

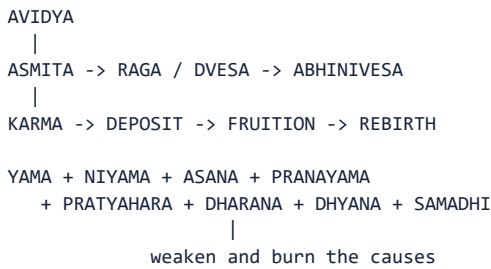
Rapid recall

- Yoga = citta-vṛtti-nirodha.
- Then the seer abides in its own nature.
- Five vṛttis; each may be klista or aklista.
- Means: abhyasa and vairagya.
- Trap: nirodha is not destruction of consciousness.

Progress: 3 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Klesas, Karma and Astanga Yoga: The Causal Therapy of Bondage

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - diagnosis and treatment



In simple words: Yoga treats bondage as a causal illness. Ignorance produces ego-identification, attachment, aversion and fear; these colour action and continue the cycle. The eight limbs transform conduct, embodiment and attention at progressively deeper levels.

Memory line: ethics calms the causes that meditation must finally uproot.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

3. KLEŚAS

3.1 Statement

- FACT: **Kleśas** (klesas) are the afflictions that poison citta, generate karma and sustain saṃsāric bondage.
- FACT: They are deeper than surface thoughts: they are the causal colouring of mental life.
- FACT: Yoga lists **five kleśas**, with **avidyā** as the root.

3.2 The five kleśas at a glance

Kleśa	Core meaning	Why it binds
Avidyā	ignorance, misapprehension of reality	root of all other afflictions
Asmitā	egoity, I-am-ness	confuses puruṣa with buddhi
Rāga	attachment	pursues pleasure and repetition
Dveṣa	aversion	flees pain and breeds hostility
Abhiniveśa	clinging to life / fear of death	instinctive self-preservation binds the stream

3.3 Avidyā as the root

- FACT: Avidyā is specifically defined as mistaking:
 - the **non-eternal** for the eternal,
 - the **impure** for the pure,
 - the **painful** for the pleasant,
 - the **non-self** for the self.
- FACT: It is the matrix from which all other kleśas arise.
- ANALYSIS: Avidyā in Yoga is not merely lack of information; it is a pervasive existential misorientation.

3.4 Asmitā

- FACT: **Asmitā** is the confusion of the seer with the instrument of seeing.
- FACT: More precisely, it is the identification of **puruṣa** with **buddhi** or the internal organ.
- ANALYSIS: The ego says, "I think, I act, I suffer," because it cannot distinguish consciousness from its reflected vehicle.

3.5 Rāga

- FACT: **Rāga** is attachment arising from remembered pleasure.
- FACT: It pushes citta toward repetition and possession.
- ANALYSIS: In practical life, rāga keeps the mind outward-turned and dependent on conditions.

3.6 Dveṣa

- FACT: **Dveṣa** is aversion arising from remembered pain.
- FACT: It is the negative counterpart of rāga.
- ANALYSIS: Together rāga and dveṣa structure most reactive life: chasing the agreeable, fleeing the disagreeable.

3.7 Abhiniveśa

- FACT: **Abhiniveśa** is clinging to life, often expressed as fear of death.
- FACT: Yoga stresses that it is present **even in the learned**.
- ANALYSIS: This is a subtle and frequently tested point: abhiniveśa is not merely an intellectual error, but a deeply rooted instinctive attachment carried by latent impressions.

3.8 The four states of kleśas

- FACT: Kleśas do not always function at the same intensity.
- FACT: Tradition describes **four states**.

State	Meaning	Illustration
Prasupta	dormant	seed-like, not presently manifest
Tanu	attenuated	weakened by discipline and insight
Vicchinna	interrupted	temporarily suppressed by opposing forces
Udāra	active, expanded	fully operative in conduct and reaction

3.9 Explanation of the four states

(a) Prasupta

- FACT: The kleśa remains in latency.
- ANALYSIS: Dormancy is not destruction; favourable conditions can reactivate it.

(b) Tanu

- FACT: Through practice, austerity, meditation and discernment, afflictions are thinned out.
- ANALYSIS: This is the desirable middle state in disciplined progress.

(c) Vicchinna

- FACT: An affliction can be temporarily interrupted by the operation of another tendency.
- ANALYSIS: For example, attachment may seem absent only because fear is presently stronger.

(d) Udāra

- FACT: The kleśa becomes active and behaviour-shaping.
- ANALYSIS: Here it visibly governs speech, action and affect.

3.10 Kriyā-yoga as first therapy of kleśas

- FACT: Patañjali prescribes **kriyā-yoga** as consisting of:
 1. **tapas** — disciplined austerity or heat-generating effort,
 2. **svādhyāya** — self-study and/or recitation-study of sacred teaching,
 3. **Īśvara-praṇidhāna** — surrender or devotion to Īśvara.
- FACT: Its explicit purpose is to **attenuate kleśas** and prepare for samādhi.
- ANALYSIS: Thus Yoga begins not from abstract metaphysics alone but from deliberate re-education of habit and motive.

3.11 Dhyāna as deeper burning of kleśas

- FACT: Gross kleśa-expressions are weakened by ethical and practical discipline.
- FACT: Their subtle forms (**sūkṣma**) are burned through **dhyāna** and higher meditative absorption.
- ANALYSIS: This explains why mere moral restraint is insufficient: latent affliction survives unless its causal seed is scorched.

3.12 Causal chain of bondage

- FACT: The afflictive mechanism may be summarised as:

Kleśas → Karma → Vipāka → Āśaya → Punarjanma

- FACT: **Kleśas** motivate action.
- FACT: Action deposits karmic force.
- FACT: Karma ripens as **vipāka** (fruition).
- FACT: The residual store becomes **āśaya** or karmic deposit.
- FACT: This fuels further birth and suffering.
- ANALYSIS: The chain shows why Yoga is not satisfied with external behaviour-management; it aims at the root-affliction itself.

3.13 Karma and vipāka — kleśa-rooted moral causation

Statement. FACT: **Karmāśaya** (karmashaya; karmic deposit or stock) is the subtle store of action-traces rooted in kleśas, and **vipāka** (vipaka; fruition) is its ripening as concrete embodied experience.

Argument.

1. FACT: The karmic deposit is **kleśa-mūla** (klesha-mula; rooted in the afflictions): action binds because it is coloured by avidyā, asmitā, rāga, dveṣa and abhiniveśa.
2. FACT: Vipāka is classically threefold: **jāti** (jati; birth or species-condition), **āyus** (ayus; life-span) and **bhoga** (bhoga; experience/enjoyment-suffering).
3. FACT: **Vāsanā** (vasana; latent tendency) and **saṃskāra** (samskara; impression) explain continuity: repeated cognition and action leave traces, traces dispose future cognition and action, and the cycle becomes morally structured.
4. FACT: Yoga classifies karma as **śukla** (shukla; white), **kṛṣṇa** (krishna; black), **śukla-kṛṣṇa** (mixed white-black) and **aśukla-akṛṣṇa** (ashukla-akrishna; neither white nor black), the last being associated with the yogin whose action no longer produces ordinary bondage.
5. ANALYSIS: This matters philosophically because Yoga is not merely therapeutic psychology; it explains how psychological purification can have soteriological effect by interrupting the moral-causal engine of rebirth.
6. ANALYSIS: Therefore kleśa-attenuation (**tanū-karaṇa**, tanu-karana; thinning) and final **pratiprasava** (reabsorption into the cause) are the real targets, not temporary emotional calm.

Presupposition. FACT: Yoga presupposes a morally ordered cosmos in which subtle mental-affective causes can ripen beyond a single visible episode of experience.

Example. FACT: The **dagdha-bīja** (dagdha-bija; burnt seed) image is exam-safe: a burnt seed may retain seed-shape, but it cannot germinate; similarly attenuated and burnt kleśas lose karmic fertility.

Objection. ANALYSIS: If liberation depends on exhausting an unsurveyable stock of karmāśaya, release seems indefinitely postponed.

Reply. FACT: Yoga replies that liberating knowledge and samādhi burn the seeds of future bondage. ANALYSIS: Using later comparative vocabulary, only **prārabdha-type** (prarabdha-type; already-fructifying) embodiment continues until its momentum is spent, like a potter's wheel turning briefly after the potter stops pushing.

3.14 Why removal of kleśas leads to kaivalya

1. FACT: Kleśas are the roots of karmically binding activity.
 2. FACT: Without kleśas, karmic production and karmic reactivation cease.
 3. FACT: Without karmic deposit, the machinery of repeated birth collapses.
 4. FACT: As citta is purified and discrimination matures, samādhi becomes stable.
 5. FACT: This culminates in kaivalya.
- ANALYSIS: The 2021 20-marker demanded precisely this transition from **diagnosis of affliction** to **logic of liberation**.

3.15 Kleśa and error across schools

School	Root problem	Yoga's distinctive feature
Buddhism	avidyā + tṛṣṇā	Yoga keeps enduring puruṣa and citta-psychology
Sāṃkhya	aviveka between puruṣa and prakṛti	Yoga adds meditative psychology and Īśvara
Advaita Vedānta	avidyā/adhyāsa	Yoga has no Brahman-identity thesis
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	mithyājñāna	Yoga stresses affective affliction and meditative remedy

3.16 Mini-conclusion on kleśas

- ANALYSIS: A compact answer-line: **kleśas are the afflictive roots of saṃsāra, with avidyā as the source and kriyā-yoga plus meditation as the means of attenuation and destruction.**

4. AṢṬĀṄGA YOGA

4.1 Why include aṣṭāṅga-yoga here?

- FACT: Though the syllabus clause names citta, cittavṛtti, kleśas, samādhi and kaivalya, the path linking them is the **aṣṭāṅga** discipline.
- FACT: UPSC often expects the mediating practical architecture in any fuller answer on Yoga.
- ANALYSIS: The point is philosophical significance, not physical drill.

4.2 The eight limbs

Limb	Basic meaning	Group	Philosophical significance
Yama	restraints	bahiraṅga	social-ethical purification of conduct
Niyama	observances	bahiraṅga	positive self-cultivation and inner orientation
Āsana	posture	bahiraṅga	embodied steadiness enabling meditative work
Prāṇāyāma	regulation of breath-life-force	bahiraṅga	calms psycho-physical disturbance
Pratyāhāra	withdrawal of senses	bahiraṅga / bridge	de-links citta from compulsive object-pursuit
Dhāraṇā	concentration	antaraṅga	fixing attention on one locus
Dhyāna	meditation	antaraṅga	continuous flow toward the object
Samādhi	absorption	antaraṅga	consummated identity of attention with support

4.3 Bahiraṅga and antaraṅga

- FACT: The first five are called **bahiraṅga** — external limbs.
- FACT: The last three are **antaraṅga** — internal limbs.
- ANALYSIS: "External" does not mean unimportant; it means preparatory with respect to the subtler operations of meditative consciousness.

4.4 Yama

- FACT: The **yamas** are the great restraints governing relation to others and to desire.
- FACT: The classical list is:
 1. **ahiṃsā** — non-violence,
 2. **satya** — truthfulness,
 3. **asteya** — non-stealing,
 4. **brahmacarya** — chastity / disciplined energy,
 5. **aparigraha** — non-possessiveness.
- ANALYSIS: Philosophically, yama reduces the rajasic-tāmasic turbulence that continually destabilizes citta.

4.5 Niyama

- FACT: The **niyamas** are positive observances:
 1. **śauca** — purity,
 2. **santoṣa** — contentment,
 3. **tapas** — disciplined austerity,
 4. **svādhyāya** — self-study/scriptural recitation,
 5. **Īśvara-praṇidhāna** — surrender to Īśvara.
- ANALYSIS: Niyama gives inward form to ethical discipline and opens the citta toward reflective and devotional stabilization.

4.6 Āsana

- FACT: Āsana in classical Yoga is primarily the establishment of a **steady and comfortable posture**.
- ANALYSIS: Its significance is not gymnastic display but freedom from bodily distraction.
- ANALYSIS: A body at war with itself becomes an obstacle to meditative one-pointedness.

4.7 Prāṇāyāma

- FACT: Prāṇāyāma regulates breathing and, through it, the psycho-physical economy.
- ANALYSIS: Breath functions as a hinge between body and citta; its refinement steadies attention and weakens agitation.

4.8 Pratyāhāra

- FACT: Pratyāhāra is withdrawal of the senses from their objects.
- ANALYSIS: It is not mutilation of sensory life but release from compulsive extroversion.
- ANALYSIS: This is the transition from ethical-embodied preparation to explicitly internal yogic work.

4.9 Dhāraṇā

- FACT: Dhāraṇā is concentration: binding citta to a chosen locus.
- ANALYSIS: It is the initial stabilization of attention and the first clear sign of **ekāgratā**.

4.10 Dhyāna

- FACT: Dhyāna is uninterrupted flow of cognition toward that same object.
- ANALYSIS: Unlike dhāraṇā's effortful fixing, dhyāna is sustained continuity.
- FACT: It is also a direct means for thinning and burning subtle kleśas.

4.11 Samādhi

- FACT: Samādhi is the culmination of meditative integration wherein the object alone shines with minimal interference from discursiveness.
- ANALYSIS: Because samādhi is itself a syllabus-term, it receives separate detailed treatment in §5 below.

4.12 Saṃyama

- FACT: **Saṃyama** is the integrated operation of **dhāraṇā + dhyāna + samādhi** on one object.
- FACT: It represents the inner technical core of Yoga's contemplative method.
- ANALYSIS: Philosophically, saṃyama is the progressive refinement of intentionality until cognition becomes translucent to the structure of its object.

4.13 Aṣṭāṅga-yoga as psychology of liberation

- ANALYSIS: The eight limbs are best read as a graded transformation:
 - ethics cures gross disturbance,
 - posture and breath calm embodiment,
 - withdrawal cuts sensory dispersion,
 - concentration and meditation unify the mental stream,
 - samādhi prepares discriminative liberation.
- ANALYSIS: Thus aṣṭāṅga-yoga operationalizes the abstract definition of Yoga as citta-vṛtti-nirodha.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced moral psychology

Avidya is not missing information but systematic inversion: impermanent as permanent, impure as pure, painful as pleasant and non-self as self. The other klesas can be dormant, thinned, interrupted or active; temporary suppression is not destruction.

Karmasaya and vipaka turn psychology into a theory of samsara. Afflicted action leaves deposits that ripen as birth, lifespan and experience. The burnt-seed model explains why meditation can remove future fertility even while already-fructifying embodiment retains momentum.

Astanga is an ethical psychology rather than an exercise sequence. Without yama and niyama, concentration can magnify ego and affliction. Without the inner limbs, ethical conduct remains incomplete as a route to direct discrimination.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- **2021 Q6(a):** define all five klesas, their four states and the chain from affliction to karma, then show how removal leads to kaivalya.
- Explain kriya-yoga as tapas, svadhyaya and Isvara-pranidhana.
- Present eight limbs functionally: what disturbance each level treats.
- Never reduce asana to the whole of Yoga or treat ethics as optional preparation.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Root klesa: avidya.
- Asmita confuses seer and instrument.
- Raga follows pleasure; dvesa follows pain; abhinivesa clings to life.
- Eight limbs move from ethics to absorption.
- Samyama = dharana + dhyana + samadhi.

Progress: 4 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Samadhi: Object-Supported Insight, Seedless Restraint and Classification Control

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - increasingly transparent attention

ordinary mind -> one-pointed attention -> object-supported absorption
-> beyond objectification
-> even residual seed ceases

SAMPRAJNATA: cognitive support remains
ASAMPRAJNATA: vrttis cease, samskara may remain
NIRBIJA: even residual seed is restrained

In simple words: Samadhi is not sleep. It is the disciplined refinement of attention until citta becomes transparent and finally ceases producing binding object-forms.

YS 1.17 factors: vitarka, vicara, ananda, asmita
 YS 1.42-1.44 samapattis: savitarka/nirvitarka,
 savicara/nirvicara
 These are related grids, not the same list.

Memory line: preserve the classification before explaining the ascent.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

5. SAMĀDHI

5.1 Statement

- FACT: **Samādhi** (samadhi) is meditative absorption in which citta becomes radically unified and transparent.
- FACT: It is not mere passivity; it is the highest refinement of attention and the threshold of liberating discernment.
- FACT: Classical Yoga distinguishes two main forms: **samprajñāta** and **asamprajñāta** samādhi.

5.2 Samprajñāta samādhi — with object / with seed

- FACT: **Samprajñāta samādhi** is cognitive or object-oriented absorption.
- FACT: A support remains; there is still a subtle seed of cognition.
- FACT: It is called **sabīja** (YS 1.46) because an object-support ("seed") is still present.
- ANALYSIS: **Two senses of "seed" must be kept apart:** in YS 1.46 *sabīja* means "with object-support", whereas the *bīja* denied in *nirbīja* at YS 1.51 is the residual **saṃskāra**. Losing the object-support therefore does not by itself make a samādhi *nirbīja*.
- ANALYSIS: The mind is profoundly stilled, but not utterly free of object-reference.

5.3 Two canonical schemes that must not be conflated

- FACT: Pātañjala Yoga uses two related but distinct classifications in the Samādhi-pāda.
- FACT: **Yogasūtra 1.17** defines **samprajñāta** samādhi through four accompanying factors: **vitarka, vicāra, ānanda, asmitā** — *vitarka-vicārānandāsmītā-rūpānugamāt samprajñātaḥ*.
- FACT: **Yogasūtra 1.42–1.44** classifies **samāpatti** (samapatti; meditative coalescence with an object) as **savitarkā/nirvitarkā** and **savicārā/nirvicārā**.
- ANALYSIS: The first scheme answers: "What characterises samprajñāta samādhi?" The second answers: "How does object-absorption differ according to conceptual-verbal overlay and object-level?"

5.4 YS 1.17: the fourfold character of samprajñāta samādhi

Factor in samprajñāta	Object-level / cognitive tone	Safe explanation
FACT: Vitarka	FACT: gross object-level engagement	FACT: absorption still accompanied by gross deliberative grasp.
FACT: Vicāra	FACT: subtle object-level reflection	FACT: attention moves from gross entities toward subtle principles.
FACT: Ānanda	FACT: refined sattvic joy/bliss-aspect	ANALYSIS: not ordinary pleasure; it is a purified meditative affect attached to sattva.
FACT: Asmitā	FACT: bare "I-am-ness"	ANALYSIS: not the ordinary kleśa-asmitā in its binding form, but the extremely subtle objectification of the I-sense.

- FACT: Therefore **sānanda** and **sāsmīta** are not a contested addition to Patañjali's list; **ānanda** and **asmitā** are explicitly present in the sūtra's own fourfold characterisation.
- ANALYSIS: What becomes interpretively delicate is not whether ānanda and asmitā belong to samprajñāta, but how later commentators map them onto the samāpatti sequence.

5.5 YS 1.42–1.46: samāpatti-bhedas, not the YS 1.17 fourfold list

Samāpatti-bheda	Object-range	Conceptual-verbal overlay	Doctrinal point
FACT: Savitarkā samāpatti	FACT: gross (sthūla) object	FACT: mixed with śabda-artha-jñāna-vikalpa (word-object-knowledge construction)	FACT: absorption still carries name, meaning and concept together.
FACT: Nirvitarkā samāpatti	FACT: gross object	FACT: memory and verbal construction are purified	FACT: the object shines more immediately without gross conceptual overlay.
FACT: Savicārā samāpatti	FACT: subtle (sūkṣma) object	FACT: subtle reflective consideration remains	FACT: absorption turns from gross objects to subtle principles.
FACT: Nirvicārā samāpatti	FACT: subtle object	FACT: even subtle reflective overlay is stilled	FACT: refined subtle-object absorption becomes luminous and clear.

- FACT: Under YS 1.44, the **savicārā/nirvicārā** pair is stated with reference to subtle objects.
- FACT: YS 1.45 extends the subtle domain up to **aliṅga** (alinga; the undifferentiated prakṛtic condition).
- FACT: YS 1.46 states that these samāpattis remain **sabīja** (sabija; with seed) samādhi.
- FACT: YS 1.47 says the clarity (**vaiśāradya**, vaisaradya; lucidity) of **nirvicārā** leads to **adhyātma-prasāda** (adhyatma-prasada; inner clarity of the self-field).
- FACT: YS 1.48 says that therein the prajñā is **ṛtambharā** (rtambhara; truth-bearing).
- FACT: **Example.** The crystal (**sphaṭika**) taking the colour of a nearby flower captures samāpatti: citta becomes so object-coloured that the object seems to shine through it.

5.6 Reconciliation: how commentators relate the two schemes

Statement. FACT: The safe reconciliation is: **vitarka-vicāra-ānanda-asmitā** are the canonical four factors of samprajñāta, while **savitarkā/nirvitarkā/savicārā/nirvicārā** are samāpatti varieties within object-supported absorption.

Argument.

1. FACT: The sa/nir- distinction concerns whether conceptual-verbal overlay (**vikalpa**, especially **śabda-artha-jñāna-vikalpa**) is present or absent in absorption.
2. FACT: The vitarka/vicāra/ānanda/asmitā series concerns the level or refinement of the object/support on which samprajñāta rests: gross -> subtle -> sattva-bliss aspect -> bare I-am-ness.
3. ANALYSIS: Vyāsa's **Yogabhāṣya** and later Vācaspati Miśra and Vijñānabhikṣu attempt to map these two analytic grids onto one graded meditative path.
4. CAUTION: Commentarial differences remain over whether **ānanda** and **asmitā** should be counted as independent samāpattis, as supervening aspects of the subtle stage, or as higher refinements beyond the four named sa/nir samāpattis.

Presupposition. FACT: The reconciliation presupposes that Patañjali can classify the same meditative ascent by different criteria: object-level, cognitive factor, and degree of conceptual purification.

Example. ANALYSIS: A student may compare it to classifying the same university course by year-level and by assessment-mode: the grids overlap, but they are not the same list.

Objection. ANALYSIS: If both schemes operate within sabīja absorption, why not simply call savitarkā, nirvitarkā, savicārā and nirvicārā the four samprajñāta stages?

Reply. FACT: Because YS 1.17 itself names the four factors of samprajñāta as vitarka, vicāra, ānanda and asmitā; the sa/nir list belongs to the later samāpatti analysis of gross and subtle object-absorption.

Safe examination formula. ANALYSIS: Write: "Patañjali characterises samprajñāta by vitarka, vicāra, ānanda and asmitā. He then analyses samāpatti as savitarkā/nirvitarkā for gross objects and savicārā/nirvicārā for subtle objects. Commentators map these schemes, but the lists should not be conflated."

5.7 Trap box: samprajñāta vs samāpatti lists

DO NOT WRITE:

"The four types of samprajñāta samādhi listed by Patañjali are savitarka, nirvitarka, savicāra and nirvicāra."

WRITE INSTEAD:

YS 1.17 fourfold samprajñāta = vitarka + vicāra + ānanda + asmitā.

YS 1.42–1.44 samāpatti-bhedas = savitarkā/nirvitarkā and savicārā/nirvicārā.

5.8 Ṛtambharā prajñā — truth-bearing insight

Statement. FACT: **Ṛtambharā prajñā** (rtambhara prajna; truth-bearing insight) is the special lucidity arising with **nirvicāra-vaiśāradya** (nirvicara-vaissaradya; clarity of subtle absorption), where citta grasps the object with exceptional purity.

Argument.

1. **FACT:** It is linked to **adhyātma-prasāda**, the inward clarity that follows the perfection of nirvicārā samāpatti.
2. **FACT:** It differs from **śruta** (sruta; scriptural/testimonial knowledge) and **anumāna** (anumana; inference), because those normally reach universals or general relations, while ṛtambharā has a **viśeṣa-artha** (visesa-artha; particular object) as its field.
3. **FACT:** Thus yogic insight reaches the individual/particular in a way ordinary testimony and inference do not.
4. **FACT:** Its saṃskāra obstructs other saṃskāras: the impression born of truth-bearing insight counteracts ordinary afflicted and dispersive impressions.
5. **FACT:** When even the saṃskāra of ṛtambharā ceases, seedless absorption (**nirbīja samādhi**, YS 1.51) becomes possible.
6. **FACT:** Yoga accepts three pramāṇas — **pratyakṣa**, **anumāna** and **āgama/śabda** — so ṛtambharā is not a fourth pramāṇa.
7. **ANALYSIS:** It is best classified as perfected **yogi-pratyakṣa** (yogi-pratyaksa; extraordinary yogic perception), an extraordinary refinement of perception rather than a new independent means of knowledge.

Presupposition. FACT: Yoga presupposes that citta can become so sattva-pure that perception is no longer distorted by ordinary conceptual, affective and karmic deposits.

Example. ANALYSIS: Ordinary inference knows "fire is present because smoke is present" as a general relation; ṛtambharā is like direct yogic disclosure of the concrete object in its particularity, without dependence on discursive mediation.

Objection. ANALYSIS: If ṛtambharā is still a citta-vṛtti, how can it help liberation rather than bind?

Reply. FACT: Yoga replies that akliṣṭa vṛttis can cancel kliṣṭa vṛttis; the truth-bearing impression blocks lower impressions and then itself ceases. **ANALYSIS:** It is a ladder that must finally be left behind.

Caution. ANALYSIS: Do not simply equate ṛtambharā with Aurobindo's "knowledge by identity" or "supermind". The resemblance is thematic only: in Yoga, ṛtambharā is a purified citta-vṛtti that must finally cease; in Aurobindo, supramental knowledge by identity is reinterpreted as a permanent, world-affirming gnosis.

5.9 Asamprajñāta samādhi — beyond cognitive objectification

- **FACT:** **Asamprajñāta samādhi** is non-cognitive or supra-cognitive absorption in which the vṛttis cease and no object stands forth as support in the ordinary sense.
- **FACT:** **YS 1.18** defines it as *virāma-pratyaya-abhyāsa-pūrvah saṃskāra-śeṣo 'nyaḥ* — "the other [samādhi] is preceded by the practice of the idea of cessation, and **has saṃskāra as its residue.**"
- **FACT:** So on the sūtra's own wording asamprajñāta is characterised by **saṃskāra-śeṣa**: latent impressions may still remain even though cognitive absorption has stopped.
- **ANALYSIS:** It is crucial not to confuse this with sleep or blank unconsciousness; it is the fruition of radical meditative restraint.

5.9A Nirbīja samādhi — when even the residual seed ceases

- FACT: **YS 1.51** states *tasyāpi nirodhe sarva-nirodhān nirbījaḥ samādhiḥ* — "on the restraint of **that too**, everything being restrained, samādhi is **seedless**."
- FACT: The "that too" is the residual impression left by the preceding stage (the saṃskāra born of ṛtambharā prajñā, YS 1.50); when even it is restrained, absorption becomes **nirbīja**.
- ANALYSIS: **Do not equate the two terms**. Asamprajñāta (YS 1.18) is defined by *residual saṃskāra*; nirbīja (YS 1.51) is defined by *the cessation of even that residue*. Nirbīja is best treated as the culminating condition reached within the asamprajñāta phase, not as a synonym for it.
- ANALYSIS: FACT: Safe answer formula: *asamprajñāta = vṛttis stopped, saṃskāra-śeṣa remains; nirbīja = even that residual saṃskāra restrained*.

5.10 Relation between saṃskāra and nirodha

- FACT: Even when active vṛttis cease, latent impressions can remain as residual potency — this is exactly the *saṃskāra-śeṣa* of YS 1.18.
- FACT: Hence the path must proceed beyond surface quietness to the restraint of even the subtle seed, which is what YS 1.51 marks as nirbīja.
- ANALYSIS: This explains why temporary calm or trance is not yet liberation.

5.11 Dharmamegha-samādhi

- FACT: **Dharmamegha-samādhi** is the highest samādhi immediately preceding kaivalya.
- FACT: The image is that of a **cloud of dharma** raining down the fullness of discriminative knowledge.
- FACT: At this level, even fascination with extraordinary knowledge or powers is relinquished.
- ANALYSIS: It marks the consummation of non-attachment: the yogin no longer seeks omniscience, attainment or display.

5.12 Samādhi and siddhis

- FACT: Higher concentrations may yield extraordinary capacities or **siddhis**.
- ANALYSIS: But Yoga warns that these are obstacles if appropriated by egoity or fascination.
- ANALYSIS: They belong to the side-effects of concentration, not to the essence of kaivalya.

5.13 Role of Īśvara in samādhi

- FACT: **Īśvara-praṇidhāna** is both a **niyama** and an independent means conducive to samādhi.
- FACT: Devotion or surrender to Īśvara stabilizes citta and helps overcome obstacles.
- FACT: Īśvara is also linked to the meditative use of **praṇava (OM)**.
- ANALYSIS: In Yoga, theism is practical: Īśvara functions as an unsurpassed focus, model and aid to concentration.

5.14 Obstacles and their removal

- FACT: Classical Yoga lists obstacles (**antarāyas**) such as disease, mental dullness, doubt, carelessness, laziness, sensuality, false perception, failure to attain stages and instability in attained stages.
- FACT: Īśvara-praṇidhāna is one of the important means of overcoming these.
- ANALYSIS: This is why questions on samādhi often open into the role of God: Yoga's God is not a creator-first doctrine but a **practice-enabling doctrine**.

5.15 Samādhi in the 2022 PYQ

- FACT: The 2022 question required the **nature and stages of samādhi** along with the **role of Īśvara**.
- ANALYSIS: Therefore a complete answer must cover the distinction between samprajñāta and asamprajñāta (including YS 1.18's *saṃskāra-śeṣa* and its further culmination in YS 1.51's nirbīja), the YS 1.17 fourfold characterisation, the samāpatti-bhedas, dharmamegha as culmination, and devotional concentration on Īśvara as an aid.

5.16 Mini-conclusion on samādhi

- ANALYSIS: A sharp answer line: **samādhi is the progressive refinement of concentration from object-supported cognitive absorption (sabīja, YS 1.46) through non-cognitive absorption with residual impressions (asamprajñāta, YS 1.18: saṃskāra-śeṣa) to the restraint of even that residue (nirbīja, YS 1.51), with YS 1.17's samprajñāta factors, the samāpatti refinements, and Īśvara-praṇidhāna as a powerful aid but not a substitute for discriminative realization.**

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced interpretive control

Samprajnata retains cognition and support. Its canonical factors are vitarka, vicara, ananda and asmita. The separate samapatti analysis distinguishes gross and subtle object-absorption according to whether conceptual-verbal overlay remains. Conflating these schemes is a major doctrinal error.

Mature nirvicara yields truth-bearing insight, but even exalted cognition remains an event in citta. Asamprajnata arises through disciplined restraint and may retain residual samskara; nirbija marks the further cessation of that seed. Therefore neither state should be equated casually with sleep or blankness.

Siddhis can accompany samyama but become obstacles when appropriated. Dharmamegha samadhi and supreme dispassion turn the path away from powers toward final discrimination.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- **2020 Q5(b):** distinguish samprajnata and asamprajnata by support, cognition, samskara and function.
- **2022 Q5(c):** present the stages accurately and integrate Isvara's instrumental role.
- State the two classification grids separately before showing commentarial reconciliation.
- Add the trap: asamprajnata is not automatically identical with nirbija.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Samprajnata: object-supported and cognitive.
- Asamprajnata: cessation with possible residual impression.
- Nirbija: even residual seed ceases.
- Rtam bhara prajna follows mature nirvicara.
- Trap: samapatti subtypes are not YS 1.17's four factors.

Progress: 5 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Kaivalya and Isvara: Isolation, Discernment and the Special Purusa

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - liberation removes confusion, not consciousness

practice + detachment
|
klesas weaken, samadhi stabilizes
|
VIVEKA-KHYATI: Purusa is not citta/Prakriti
|
supreme detachment + dharmamegha
|
KAIVALYA: Purusa abides in its own nature

ISVARA helps the path but does not replace discernment.

In simple words: Kaivalya is isolation of consciousness from material nature, not union with God or Brahman. Isvara is a perfect, eternally free Purusa who supports concentration, surrender and teaching.

Isvara is	Isvara is not
Purusa-visesa	Material cause
Untouched by klesa and karma	Ordinary karmic self
Timeless teacher	Nyaya-style creator by default
Privileged meditative support	External giver of kaivalya

Memory line: God accelerates the path; viveka completes it.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

6. KAIVALYA

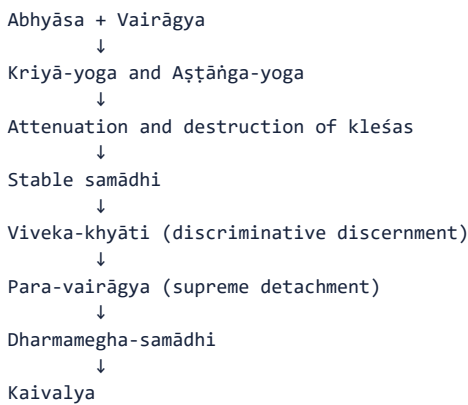
6.1 Exact meaning

- FACT: **Kaivalya** means aloneness, isolation or absolute distinctness.
- FACT: In Yoga it is the isolation of **puruṣa** from **prakṛti** and its evolutes.
- FACT: It is therefore **not** union with God, **not** merger into Brahman, and **not** mere relief from pain considered negatively.
- ANALYSIS: The precise meaning must always be guarded because UPSC frequently tests it through contrasts.

6.2 Why kaivalya is needed if puruṣa is already pure

- FACT: Puruṣa is indeed eternally pure, inactive and free.
- FACT: Yet through ignorance, citta's modifications are appropriated as self.
- FACT: Kaivalya is the cessation of this false relation at the level of experience and bondage.
- ANALYSIS: So liberation is not a production of a new essence; it is the ending of misidentification.

6.3 The process leading to kaivalya



6.4 Viveka-khyāti

- FACT: **Viveka-khyāti** is discriminative knowledge discerning the absolute difference between puruṣa and prakṛti.
- FACT: It is the decisive knowledge that ends confusion.
- ANALYSIS: Yoga thus remains deeply cognitivist at the summit: samādhi is indispensable, but its soteriological function is to mature discriminative discernment.

6.5 Para-vairāgya

- FACT: **Para-vairāgya** is supreme detachment even from the highest subtle attainments.
- FACT: The yogin ceases to crave powers, experiences, pleasures, even exalted cognitive states.
- ANALYSIS: Without this, subtle egoity can survive advanced practice.

6.6 Dharmamegha and final transition

- FACT: In **dharmamegha-samādhi**, the cloud of dharma pours down the fullness of liberating discernment.
- FACT: The final barriers to isolation of puruṣa are removed.
- ANALYSIS: This is not a divine grace replacing effort; it is the ripened summit of perfected discipline and discernment.

6.7 Pratiprasava of the guṇas

- FACT: With liberation, the **guṇas** cease to function for the liberated puruṣa and resolve back toward their source.
- FACT: This return or involution is described as **pratiprasava** — reabsorption back into prakṛti.
- FACT: Citta, as a product of prakṛti, no longer binds; its function is exhausted.
- ANALYSIS: The metaphor is one of reversal of the evolutionary process for soteriological purposes.

6.8 Kaivalya transition: farmer, burnt seed and potter's wheel

- FACT: The Kaivalya-pāda uses the **kṣetrika** (ksetrika; farmer) image: the farmer does not push water into the field by force; he breaches the embankment, and water flows by its own nature.
- ANALYSIS: Exam use: yogic discipline removes obstructions; it does not manufacture puruṣa's freedom, because puruṣa is already free and prakṛti's processes complete themselves when obstacles are removed.
- FACT: The burnt seed (**dagdha-bīja**) image explains why destroyed kleśas cannot germinate into future bondage.
- ANALYSIS: The potter's wheel image explains residual embodiment: even after liberating knowledge removes the push of fresh karma, the already-moving psycho-physical complex may continue briefly until its momentum is exhausted.
- ANALYSIS: This allows a careful account of **jīvanmukti** (jivanmukti; liberation while living) language in Yoga: the puruṣa is no longer bound, though bodily-citta processes may continue until their residual cause is spent.

6.9 Svarūpa-pratiṣṭhā

- FACT: Kaivalya may also be expressed as the abiding of consciousness in its own nature — **svarūpa-pratiṣṭhā**.
- ANALYSIS: This continues the logic of the foundational sūtra: when vṛttis cease, the seer stands in itself.

6.10 How Yoga kaivalya differs from Advaita mokṣa

Yoga	Advaita Vedānta
many puruṣas	one Brahman as ultimate reality
liberation = isolation of puruṣa from prakṛti	liberation = realization of identity of ātman and Brahman
no Brahman-doctrine	Brahman central
no merger or non-dual identity	mokṣa is non-dual realization

- ANALYSIS: Therefore kaivalya is not identity but **disentanglement**.
- ANALYSIS: Cross-reference: Vedānta.

6.11 How Yoga kaivalya differs from Nyāya apavarga

Yoga kaivalya	Nyāya apavarga
positive isolation of pure consciousness in its own nature	often described as cessation of pain and bondage
rooted in puruṣa-prakṛti discrimination	rooted in true knowledge of categories and self
citta resolves, puruṣa shines	self remains but liberation is characterized more negatively

- ANALYSIS: UPSC-safe line: **Nyāya emphasizes cessation of suffering; Yoga emphasizes the isolation and self-abidance of puruṣa.**
- ANALYSIS: Cross-reference: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika.

6.12 Īśvara and kaivalya

- FACT: Īśvara assists the aspirant but does **not grant** kaivalya as an external gift.
- FACT: Liberation finally depends on the yogin's own **viveka-khyāti**.
- FACT: Īśvara is the perfect model, object of devotion and remover of obstacles.
- ANALYSIS: This is central to the 2025 demand on the nature of God and his role in kaivalya.

6.13 What kaivalya is not

- ANALYSIS: Not **union with God** in the bhakti-school sense.
- ANALYSIS: Not **identity with Brahman** in the Advaitic sense.
- ANALYSIS: Not **annihilation of consciousness**.
- ANALYSIS: Not **mere painlessness** abstracted from the self's own luminosity.
- ANALYSIS: Not **destruction of mind as substance**; rather, cessation of its binding modifications and reabsorption of its function into prakṛti.

6.14 Mini-conclusion on kaivalya

- ANALYSIS: Best exam sentence: **kaivalya is the isolation of puruṣa from prakṛti, reached through discriminative discernment matured in samādhi, with guṇas returning to quiescence and consciousness abiding in its own form.**

7. ĪŚVARA IN YOGA

7.1 Why a separate section is necessary

- FACT: Though the syllabus clause names citta through kaivalya, UPSC repeatedly asks the role of **God** in Yoga.
- FACT: Yoga's distinctiveness from Sāṃkhya cannot be fully explained without Īśvara.
- ANALYSIS: Hence any mature note on Yoga must include a separate theistic section.

7.2 Definition: puruṣa-viśeṣa

- FACT: Yoga defines **Īśvara** as a **puruṣa-viśeṣa** — a special puruṣa.
- FACT: He is untouched by **kleśa**, **karma**, **vipāka** and **āśaya**.
- FACT: This is the standard doctrinal core of the Yoga-sūtra account.

7.3 Omniscience and timeless teacherhood

- FACT: In Īśvara lies the unsurpassed seed of omniscience.
- FACT: He is the teacher of the ancients and is not limited by time.
- FACT: He is denoted by **praṇava (OM)**.
- ANALYSIS: These predicates make Īśvara the ideal meditative and pedagogic principle in Yoga.

7.4 Īśvara is not creator in the Nyāya sense

- FACT: Yoga does **not** primarily present Īśvara as creator-God.
- FACT: **Prakṛti** remains the material basis of worldly evolution.
- FACT: Evolution proceeds through the puruṣa-prakṛti framework, not through divine creation ex nihilo.
- ANALYSIS: Therefore Yoga's God differs sharply from the Nyāya God as **nimitta-kāraṇa** or efficient cause of the world-order.

7.5 Īśvara is not a Vaiṣṇava-style personal saviour

- FACT: Though devotion to Īśvara is accepted, Yoga does not make him a saviour who arbitrarily grants liberation.
- FACT: The structure of liberation remains impersonal in one crucial sense: it depends on the yogin's own discriminative realization.
- ANALYSIS: This must be clearly said to avoid importing later devotional theologies into classical Yoga.

7.6 Positive role of Īśvara

Role of Īśvara in Yoga	Explanation
Object of meditation	one-pointed devotion stabilizes citta
Aid through Īśvara-praṇidhāna	surrender reduces egoity and attachment
Remover of obstacles	helps counter antarāyas in practice
Perfect model	exemplifies untouched, unsurpassed spiritual status
Teacher principle	anchor of timeless transmission and authority

7.7 Why Yoga is called seśvara-sāṃkhya

- FACT: Because it preserves the Sāṃkhyan dualistic ontology while adding Īśvara.
- FACT: Hence the expression **seśvara-sāṃkhya** — Sāṃkhya with God.
- ANALYSIS: This is not a small decorative addition; it changes the psychological and devotional resources of the path while leaving the basic metaphysical dualism intact.

7.8 Īśvara and praṇava

- FACT: Meditation on **OM** as the designation of Īśvara is a canonical Yogic practice.
- ANALYSIS: This links theology, language, sound and contemplative concentration in a single discipline.

7.9 Īśvara, samādhi and kaivalya together

- FACT: Īśvara aids samādhi by offering a privileged support for concentration.
- FACT: Through obstacle-removal and ego-surrender, the aspirant's path to discriminative knowledge is accelerated.
- FACT: But kaivalya still follows from **viveka-khyāti**, not divine fiat.
- ANALYSIS: Thus the most accurate exam formula is: **Īśvara is instrumental, not constitutive, in liberation.**

7.10 The 2025 demand

- FACT: The 2025 question asked for the **nature of God and his role in kaivalya**.
- ANALYSIS: A strong answer should therefore establish four points:
 1. Īśvara is a **special puruṣa**.
 2. He is untouched by kleśa-karma-vipāka-āśaya.
 3. He aids concentration, removes obstacles and is the object of praṇava-mediated devotion.
 4. He does not create the world in the Nyāya sense and does not bestow kaivalya independently of viveka-khyāti.

7.11 Mini-conclusion on Īśvara

- ANALYSIS: In Yoga, God is best understood as **the supreme contemplative support within a Sāṃkhyan metaphysical frame**.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced necessity and redundancy

Kaivalya is needed at the empirical level even though Purusa is eternally pure because misidentification operates through citta. Discipline removes obstructions like a farmer opening a channel; it does not manufacture freedom. Burnt seed and potter's wheel images explain the end of future bondage and residual embodiment.

Isvara is metaphysically limited but practically significant. He neither becomes the world nor grants liberation by fiat. As timeless teacher, perfect exemplar and pranava-supported meditative object, he de-centres ego and removes obstacles.

The redundancy objection therefore has force: Samkhya ontology and viveka can formally explain liberation without God. Yoga's strongest reply is soteriological rather than cosmological—practical indispensability for some aspirants need not imply creatorhood.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- **2025 Q7(b):** define Isvara precisely, explain positive functions and state why kaivalya still depends on viveka-khyati.
- Distinguish Yoga kaivalya from Advaita identity and Nyaya's cessation-centred apavarga.
- Explain pratiprasava and svarupa-pratistha.
- Never write that liberation is union with Isvara.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Kaivalya = isolation/self-establishment of Purusa.
- Path culminates in viveka-khyati and supreme detachment.
- Isvara is special Purusa, pranava's referent and timeless teacher.
- Isvara is instrumental, not constitutive, in liberation.
- Trap: Yoga is Sesvara, but not creator-theism in the straightforward Nyaya sense.

Progress: 6 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Inter-School Debates, Realism, Criticisms and UPSC Traps

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - four major comparison axes

SAMKHYA -> same ontology, no Isvara, less detailed praxis
NYAYA -> self-substance and creator God
ADVAITA -> one Brahman, liberation as identity
BUDDHISM-> no permanent Purusa, process-based meditation
YOGA -> plural witnesses, realist objects, disciplined isolation

In simple words: Yoga must be located through exact contrasts. It is not merely Samkhya plus a decorative God, not Advaitic union, not Buddhist no-self and not Nyaya creator-theism.

Memory line: compare self, God, causation, mind and liberation one axis at a time.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

8. INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES

8.1 Yoga and Sāṃkhya

Issue	Sāṃkhya	Yoga
Metaphysical base	puruṣa-prakṛti dualism; 25 tattvas	same basic ontology
God	nirīśvara	seśvara — admits Īśvara
Main stress	explanatory metaphysics, viveka-jñāna	practical psychology, meditative discipline, samādhi
Liberation	kaivalya through discrimination	kaivalya through discrimination matured by yoga-practice

- ANALYSIS: Yoga does not reject Sāṃkhya; it operationalizes it.

8.2 Yoga and Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika

Issue	Yoga	Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika
Internal organ	citta as broad mind-complex	atomic manas plus self-substance
God	special puruṣa, aid to meditation	creator/efficient cause and moral governor
Liberation	kaivalya as isolation of puruṣa	apavarga as cessation of suffering
Valid knowledge	3 pramāṇas	4 pramāṇas

8.3 Yoga and Vedānta

Issue	Yoga	Advaita Vedānta
Ultimate reality	many puruṣas + prakṛti	non-dual Brahman
Bondage	confusion of puruṣa with citta/prakṛti	avidyā/adhyāsa causing Brahman-self ignorance
Liberation	isolation	identity-realization
God	meditative aid, special puruṣa	saguṇa Brahman at vyāvahārika level

8.4 Yoga and Buddhism

Issue	Yoga	Buddhism
Self	enduring puruṣa	nairātmyavāda/no permanent self
Affliction	kleśas rooted in avidyā	kleśa/trṣṇā/avidyā nexus
Meditation	samādhi aimed at puruṣa-prakṛti discrimination	meditation aimed at insight into impermanence, non-self, dependent origination
Liberation	kaivalya	nirvāṇa

8.5 Kaivalya-pāda realism against Vijñānavāda/Yogācāra

Statement. FACT: The Kaivalya-pāda contains a genuine realist polemic: Yoga is not a mind-only idealism but a Sāṃkhya-realist system in which objects, citta and puruṣa are distinct.

Pūrvapakṣa. ANALYSIS: **Vijñānavāda/Yogācāra** argues that what is taken as an external object can be explained as cognition-only; the object need not be admitted as independently real.

Siddhānta. FACT: Yoga's reply is Sāṃkhya-realism: objects are not reducible to a single cognition, citta is itself knowable, and puruṣa is required as the witness of the mind.

Argument.

1. FACT: **Vastu-sāmya / ekacitta-tantra argument.** An object is not dependent on one mind; if it were **ekacitta-tantra** (ekacitta-tantra; dependent on a single mind), it would vanish when that mind ceased to cognise it. ANALYSIS: The persistence and common availability of objects support object-realism.
2. FACT: **Mind's knownness argument.** Citta is not self-illuminating (**na tat svābhāsam**, na tat svabhasam), because it is itself **dr̥śya** (dr̥śya; an object seen) for puruṣa. ANALYSIS: A purely mind-only theory struggles to terminate the regress of cognitions cognising cognitions.
3. FACT: **Against simultaneous self-cognition.** The mind cannot fully apprehend itself and its object in the same act as though it were both lamp and illuminated object. ANALYSIS: Yoga therefore distinguishes the object, the mental modification and the witnessing puruṣa.
4. FACT: **Uparāga argument.** An object is known when citta is **uparakta** (uparakta; coloured/affected) by it; whether the object is known or unknown depends on citta's colouring, which implies that the object is not identical with the cognition itself.

Presupposition. FACT: The argument presupposes Yoga's three-term realism: object (**viśaya**), mental modification (**citta-vṛtti**) and witness (**puruṣa**) are analytically distinct.

Example. FACT: The sphaṭika crystal near a flower again helps: the crystal becomes coloured by the flower, but the flower is not created by the crystal's colouration; similarly, citta is coloured by an object that stands outside the cognition.

Objection. ANALYSIS: The Yogācāra can reply that shared karmic traces explain intersubjective object-appearance without positing external objects.

Reply. ANALYSIS: Yoga reconstructs the answer by insisting that shared appearance itself is better explained by a common object plus multiple cittas than by private cognitions alone; the residual force is that Yoga must still explain precisely how external objects colour an insentient but subtle citta.

Exam payoff. ANALYSIS: This material shows that Yoga is not only a praxis manual; it defends a metaphysically committed realism against Buddhist idealism.

8.6 Yoga and philosophy of religion

- ANALYSIS: Yoga's Īśvara is useful for cross-paper deployment with Notions of God and Religious Experience.
- ANALYSIS: It represents a distinctive Indian model of God as contemplative principle rather than creator-first metaphysical absolute.

9. CRITICISMS AND REPLIES

9.1 Criticism: If puruṣa is inactive and pure, how can it ever be bound?

- ANALYSIS: The objection is that an inactive witness cannot genuinely enter bondage.
- FACT: Yoga's reply parallels Sāṃkhya: bondage belongs not to puruṣa intrinsically but to misidentification through reflection in citta.
- ANALYSIS: Thus bondage is phenomenological and epistemic, not an actual alteration of puruṣa.

9.2 Criticism: If citta is insentient, how can cognition occur at all?

- ANALYSIS: The challenge targets the possibility of experience in an unconscious psychical instrument.
- FACT: Yoga replies that citta becomes luminous by reflecting puruṣa, just as a crystal appears lit by what is near it.
- ANALYSIS: The school thus explains cognition through a relation of reflected consciousness rather than by attributing intrinsic consciousness to matter.

9.3 Criticism: Why count valid cognition itself as a vṛtti if it helps liberation?

- ANALYSIS: If pramāṇa is true, why restrain it?
- FACT: Yoga replies that even true cognition is still a modification.
- FACT: It is useful in its **akliṣṭa** form as a ladder toward viveka-khyāti.
- ANALYSIS: But what serves as means at one stage must also finally be transcended.

9.4 Criticism: Is asamprajñāta samādhi just unconsciousness or sleep?

- FACT: No.
- FACT: Sleep is itself one vṛtti, while asamprajñāta samādhi is cessation of vṛttis through discipline.
- ANALYSIS: The difference lies in both genesis and value: sleep is natural obscuration; samādhi is luminous restraint.

9.5 Criticism: Why add Īśvara if Sāṃkhya ontology already explains liberation?

- ANALYSIS: This is the classic challenge from nirīśvara Sāṃkhya.
- FACT: Yoga's answer is pragmatic and soteriological: Īśvara offers a unique focus of devotion, removes obstacles and supports samādhi.
- ANALYSIS: The addition is justified by practical efficacy rather than by an overhaul of metaphysical fundamentals.

9.6 Criticism: If liberation depends on viveka-khyāti, does God become redundant?

- FACT: Not redundant, but non-final.
- FACT: Īśvara is a privileged aid, not the substitute for discernment.
- ANALYSIS: This balanced answer is exactly what UPSC expects.

9.7 Criticism: Is Yoga's liberation merely negative isolation?

- ANALYSIS: Some critics see kaivalya as a stark separation lacking fullness.
- FACT: Yoga replies that the positive side of liberation is **svarūpa-pratiṣṭhā** — abiding in pure consciousness free from all alien admixture.
- ANALYSIS: Its positivity is not ecstatic union but unconfused self-abidance.

9.8 Criticism: Is dhyāna sufficient without ethics?

- FACT: Yoga's answer is no.
- FACT: Without yama and niyama, meditative power can coexist with affliction and egoity.
- ANALYSIS: This is why the system places ethics at the foundation of contemplative success.

10. COMMON UPSC TRAPS

1. ANALYSIS: **Kaivalya ≠ Advaita mokṣa ≠ Nyāya apavarga**. Yoga's kaivalya is isolation of puruṣa, not identity with Brahman and not merely cessation of pain.
2. ANALYSIS: **Yoga's Īśvara is not a creator-God in the Nyāya sense**. Do not import nimitta-kāraṇa language uncritically.
3. ANALYSIS: **Citta is not identical with manas alone**. It includes buddhi, ahaṃkāra and manas functioning together.
4. ANALYSIS: **Samprajñāta and asamprajñāta must not be reversed, and asamprajñāta must not be flatly equated with nirbīja**. Samprajñāta still has object-support (*sabīja*, YS 1.46); asamprajñāta (YS 1.18) is defined as *saṃskāra-śeṣa*, i.e. residual impressions may still remain; nirbīja (YS 1.51) is the further condition in which even that residual saṃskāra is restrained.
5. ANALYSIS: **Do not conflate YS 1.17 with YS 1.42–1.44**. Samprajñāta's four factors are vitarka, vicāra, ānanda and asmitā; savitarkā/nirvitarkā/savicārā/nirvicārā are samāpatti-bhedas.
6. ANALYSIS: **Kliṣṭa/akliṣṭa qualifies vṛttis, not kleśas**. Kleśas are inherently afflictive.
7. ANALYSIS: **Citta-vṛtti-nirodha does not mean violent destruction of mind**. It means cessation of modifications so the seer abides in itself.
8. ANALYSIS: **Abhiniveśa is present even in the wise**. Do not reduce it to mere doctrinal ignorance.
9. ANALYSIS: **Sleep is a vṛtti, not liberation**. Nidrā is not samādhi.
10. ANALYSIS: **Yoga shares Sāṃkhya's tattva framework**. Do not write as if Yoga has a wholly separate cosmology.
11. ANALYSIS: **Īśvara helps but does not grant kaivalya from outside**. Liberation finally follows viveka-khyāti.

11. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK

11.1 Keywords

- FACT: **citta** — mind-complex
- FACT: **cittavṛtti** — modification of citta
- FACT: **nirodha** — restraint/cessation
- FACT: **draṣṭṛ / draṣṭā** — the seer
- FACT: **svarūpe'vasthānam** — abiding in one's own nature
- FACT: **kleśa** — affliction
- FACT: **avidyā** — root ignorance
- FACT: **asmitā** — egoity
- FACT: **rāga-dveṣa** — attachment-aversion pair
- FACT: **abhiniveśa** — clinging to life
- FACT: **abhyāsa** — sustained practice
- FACT: **vairāgya** — detachment
- FACT: **kriyā-yoga** — tapas, svādhyāya, Īśvara-praṇidhāna
- FACT: **bahiraṅga / antaraṅga** — external/internal limbs
- FACT: **saṁyama** — dhāraṇā + dhyāna + samādhi
- FACT: **viveka-khyāti** — discriminative discernment
- FACT: **dharmamegha-samādhi** — cloud-of-dharma samādhi
- FACT: **pratiprasava** — involution of guṇas
- FACT: **kaivalya** — aloneness/isolation
- FACT: **puruṣa-viśeṣa** — special puruṣa, Īśvara

11.2 Statement bank

1. FACT: "**Yogaś-citta-vṛtti-nirodhaḥ.**" Yoga is the restraint of the modifications of citta.
2. FACT: "**Tadā draṣṭuḥ svarūpe'vasthānam.**" Then the seer abides in its own nature.
3. FACT: **Īśvara is a special puruṣa untouched by kleśa, karma, vipāka and āśaya.**
4. ANALYSIS: **Citta is a reflective instrument: it borrows consciousness from puruṣa and colour from objects.**
5. ANALYSIS: **Avidyā is not simple ignorance of facts but existential misapprehension of self and value.**
6. ANALYSIS: **Akliṣṭa vṛttis are therapeutic ladders; even they are ultimately transcended.**
7. ANALYSIS: **Kaivalya is isolation, not union.**
8. ANALYSIS: **Yoga is Sāṁkhya made practical and theistic.**

<!-- expanded-pyq-depth:start -->

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (complete 2018–2025 audit)

- ANALYSIS: **Priority:** Primary ownership is 7 of 112 parts; 2018 is the only year without an owned part, although Yoga appears secondarily in the Nyāya proof-of-God comparison.
- FACT: **Required doctrinal depth:** The restored 2020 demand requires an exact distinction between samprajñāta and asamprajñāta samādhi, including cognitive support, saṁskāra residue and relation to seedless absorption.
- WRONG: **Trap / answer consequence:** Do not equate asamprajñāta with sleep or automatically with final kaivalya; state the role of prior discipline and latent impressions.

<!-- expanded-pyq-depth:end -->

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced realist and interaction debates

Against Yogacara, Yoga defends three-term realism: external object, citta-modification and witnessing Purusa. Objects are not dependent on one mind, and citta cannot be self-luminous because it is itself seen. Shared karmic appearance remains a sophisticated idealist counter.

The recurring internal objection concerns dualist interaction. Reflection and proximity explain why Purusa does not change, but critics may still ask how ontologically distinct principles jointly constitute experience.

Yoga is strongest as operational moral psychology: it connects habit, attention, memory, latent impression, affliction and meditative transformation. Its metaphysical claims about Purusa, rebirth and yogic perception face a greater public verification burden.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

Use a dialectic grid: **opponent -> target -> Yoga reply -> residual force.**

High-risk checks:

1. Citta is not manas alone.
2. Pramana can be true and still be a vrtti.
3. Nidra is not samadhi.
4. Klista/aklista qualifies vrttis, not klesas.
5. Isvara assists but does not bestow kaivalya externally.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Samkhya supplies metaphysics; Yoga adds praxis and Isvara.
- Yoga defends external objects against mind-only theory.
- Strongest area: integrated ethics and psychology.
- Weakest area: Purusa-Prakriti interaction and limited divine necessity.
- Trap: public wellness Yoga is not the whole Patanjala system.

Progress: 7 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Advanced Ledgers, Comparative Positioning and the Graded Verdict

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - critical evaluation sequence

DOCTRINE -> PRESUPPOSITION -> OBJECTION
-> YOGA REPLY -> RESIDUAL PRESSURE -> VERDICT

Example:

citta restraint -> citta is real and distinct from Purusa
-> Buddhist stream objection
-> continuing substrate bears samskaras
-> stream theory still remains possible

In simple words: evaluation must expose what each doctrine assumes and whether Yoga's reply fully answers the named rival.

Memory line: the reply matters, but so does what survives the reply.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

11A. PRESUPPOSITION LEDGER

Doctrine	Presupposition it rests on	What collapses if the presupposition is denied
FACT: Citta-vṛtti-nirodha	FACT: Citta really takes forms, can be restrained, and is distinct from puruṣa.	ANALYSIS: Nirodha becomes mere mental quietism, not liberation.
FACT: Kleśa theory	FACT: Avidyā and its derivatives causally colour cognition, action and rebirth.	ANALYSIS: Yoga loses its diagnosis of bondage and becomes moral advice only.
FACT: Reflection/asmitā	FACT: Puruṣa is inactive consciousness; citta is transparent but insentient.	ANALYSIS: Bondage of a pure puruṣa becomes inexplicable.
FACT: Aṣṭāṅga-yoga	FACT: Body, conduct, breath, senses and attention condition citta's purity.	ANALYSIS: Samādhi becomes disconnected from ethics and discipline.
FACT: Samādhi	FACT: Attention can become progressively object-transparent and finally seedless.	ANALYSIS: Meditation reduces to trance or concentration without soteriological force.
FACT: Karma-vipāka	FACT: Actions leave subtle deposits rooted in kleśas and ripen across experience.	ANALYSIS: Yoga becomes therapeutic psychology rather than a theory of saṃsāra and release.
FACT: Īśvara	FACT: A special puruṣa untouched by kleśa-karma-vipāka-āśaya is possible and useful for practice.	ANALYSIS: Yoga collapses toward nirīśvara Sāṃkhya and loses its distinctive devotional aid.
FACT: Kaivalya	FACT: Puruṣa is ultimately distinct from prakṛti, and prakṛti functions for puruṣa's experience and release.	ANALYSIS: Isolation becomes unintelligible; Advaitic identity or Buddhist no-self becomes more plausible.

11B. PŪRVAPAKṢA–SIDDHĀNTA LEDGER

Objector	Objection	Yoga's reply	Residual force ANALYSIS:
FACT: Buddhist kṣaṇikavāda	ANALYSIS: No persisting citta is needed; a stream of momentary cognitions explains experience.	FACT: Yoga invokes citta as a continuing prakṛtic substrate bearing saṃskāras and undergoing pariṇāma.	ANALYSIS: Momentariness can still explain continuity through causal series without a substance.
FACT: Yogācāra/Vijñānavāda	ANALYSIS: External objects are unnecessary; cognition-only explains appearance.	FACT: Kaivalya-pāda realism: objects are not dependent on a single mind, and citta is known by puruṣa.	ANALYSIS: Shared karmic appearance remains a sophisticated idealist counter.
FACT: Advaita Vedānta	ANALYSIS: Why many puruṣas, and why make Īśvara only a special puruṣa rather than the sole reality?	ANALYSIS: Yoga replies from experience-plurality, Sāṃkhyan realism and the practical need for discriminating each puruṣa from prakṛti.	ANALYSIS: Advaita presses the unity of consciousness more radically.
FACT: Nyāya	ANALYSIS: The self is a substance with adventitious consciousness; why call puruṣa consciousness itself, and why desire cessation of all vṛttis?	ANALYSIS: Yoga replies that consciousness cannot be an accidental property of the true seer, and nirodha reveals rather than destroys awareness.	ANALYSIS: Nyāya's commonsense realism about persons and cognition remains attractive.
FACT: Cārvāka	ANALYSIS: Puruṣa, karma, rebirth and kaivalya are unverifiable beyond perception.	ANALYSIS: Yoga replies through disciplined yogi-pratyakṣa, pragmatic transformation and the inadequacy of material pleasure to end suffering.	ANALYSIS: Public verification remains difficult.
FACT: Mīmāṃsā	ANALYSIS: A non-creator Īśvara is otiose; ritual action, not yoga, secures dharma.	ANALYSIS: Yoga replies that ritual cannot by itself remove avidyā/asmitā, while Īśvara-praṇidhāna directly stabilizes citta.	ANALYSIS: The traditional Yoga proof of Īśvara's necessity is weaker than Nyāya's creator-God argument.

11C. INTER-SCHOOL POSITIONING

School	Number of pramāṇas	Ontology of self	Status of God	Theory of causation	Nature of liberation	Jīvanmukti?
FACT: Yoga	FACT: 3: pratyakṣa, anumāna, āgama/śabda	FACT: many puruṣas, pure inactive consciousness	FACT: Īśvara as puruṣa-viśeṣa	FACT: satkāryavāda/pariṇāmovāda for prakṛti	FACT: kaivalya, isolation of puruṣa	ANALYSIS: qualified residual-embodiment language; final isolation when causes are exhausted
FACT: Sāṃkhya	FACT: 3	FACT: many puruṣas	FACT: classical nirīśvara tendency	FACT: satkāryavāda/pariṇāmovāda	FACT: kaivalya through viveka	ANALYSIS: broadly compatible with liberated-while-living language
FACT: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	FACT: 4	FACT: self as enduring substance with qualities	FACT: creator/efficient cause God in later Nyāya	FACT: ārambhavāda/asatkāryavāda	FACT: apavarga as cessation of suffering	ANALYSIS: not central; liberation usually after embodied bondage ceases
ANALYSIS: Buddhism	ANALYSIS: often 2 in epistemological schools: pratyakṣa and anumāna	FACT: no permanent self	FACT: no creator God	FACT: dependent origination, often with kṣaṇikavāda	FACT: nirvāṇa	FACT: nirvāṇa-with-remainder in some frameworks
ANALYSIS: Jainism	ANALYSIS: pramāṇas grouped as direct/indirect with subdivisions	FACT: many jīvas	FACT: no creator God; perfected siddhas	FACT: real substance with changing modes under anekāntavāda	FACT: kevala-jñāna and final siddhahood	FACT: embodied kevalin before final release
ANALYSIS: Mīmāṃsā	CAUTION: sub-school variation, commonly 5 or 6	FACT: enduring self	FACT: creator God not necessary in classical ritualism	FACT: ritual action produces apūrva	FACT: cessation of bondage / attainment linked to dharma	ANALYSIS: not a central doctrine
FACT: Advaita Vedānta	FACT: commonly 6	FACT: one non-dual ātman-Brahman	FACT: Īśvara as saguṇa Brahman at empirical level	FACT: vivartavāda at the highest level	FACT: mokṣa as Brahman-realization	FACT: strongly admitted

Precise Sāṃkhya–Yoga difference. FACT: Yoga is not merely "Sāṃkhya plus God" in a decorative sense.

ANALYSIS: It retains Sāṃkhya's puruṣa-prakṛti ontology but adds (i) **Īśvara-praṇidhāna** as a practical means, (ii) a more elaborate psychology of citta-vṛtti-nirodha, (iii) samādhi-methodology and yogi-pratyakṣa, and (iv) a systematic path from kleśa-attenuation to kaivalya. ANALYSIS: In a discuss-answer, say: **Sāṃkhya supplies the metaphysical grammar; Yoga turns it into a disciplined technology of liberation with Īśvara as a privileged contemplative aid.**

11D. CONTROLLED WESTERN COMPARISON

Western parallel	Point of contact	Disanalogy / limit
ANALYSIS: Husserl's epoché/reduction vs nirodha	ANALYSIS: Both suspend the natural attitude toward ordinary experience.	ANALYSIS: Epoché is methodological and retains the constituting ego; nirodha is soteriological and aims at cessation of the mental stream's binding modifications.
ANALYSIS: Descartes' cogito vs puruṣa	ANALYSIS: Both make consciousness indubitable.	ANALYSIS: The cogito yields a thinking substance that acts; puruṣa is inactive, non-agentive witness-consciousness.
ANALYSIS: Kant's transcendental unity of apperception vs asmitā	ANALYSIS: Both notice an "I think" accompanying representations.	ANALYSIS: Kant makes it a condition of objectivity; Yoga treats egoic I-am-appropriation as an affliction to be dissolved.
ANALYSIS: Spinoza's third kind of knowledge vs ṛtambharā	ANALYSIS: Both are non-discursive and higher than ordinary inference.	ANALYSIS: Spinoza's is knowledge of God/Nature under an attribute; Yoga's ṛtambharā is object-specific insight that must itself cease.
ANALYSIS: Aristotle's habituation vs abhyāsa-vairāgya	ANALYSIS: Both transform character through repeated discipline.	ANALYSIS: Aristotle aims at virtuous flourishing in the polis; Yoga aims at disentangling puruṣa from prakṛti.
ANALYSIS: Freud's unconscious vs saṃskāra/vāsanā	ANALYSIS: Both posit latent dispositions shaping conduct.	ANALYSIS: Saṃskāras are karmically indexed and metaphysically real deposits in a rebirth framework, not merely a psychodynamic hypothesis.

Rubric. ANALYSIS: Western parallels are illustrative garnish only; they never substitute for the Indian argument, and in an answer they must appear as at most one or two lines after the Yoga case is complete.

11E. DIRECTIVE DECODER

Directive	What the examiner is testing	The structural move for a Yoga answer	How the closing verdict must be phrased
FACT: Explain	FACT: Accuracy of definition and canonical classification.	FACT: Define the term, give the list/stages, add a brief mechanism.	ANALYSIS: "Thus X functions as Y in Yoga's path to kaivalya."
FACT: Discuss	FACT: Breadth plus significance.	FACT: Doctrine -> significance -> interpretive spread -> exam trap.	ANALYSIS: Balanced but affirmative: "Hence the doctrine is central, though not exhaustive."
FACT: Examine	FACT: Internal logic and assumptions.	FACT: State claim, unpack premises, show consequence for citta/kleśa/samādhi/kaivalya.	ANALYSIS: "On its own presuppositions, the doctrine coherently explains..."
FACT: Critically examine	FACT: Objection-handling.	FACT: Doctrine -> named objection -> Yoga reply -> residual weakness.	ANALYSIS: Guarded verdict: "Strong as phenomenology/practice, weaker at metaphysical interaction."
FACT: Analyse	FACT: Causal structure.	FACT: Break into mechanism: avidyā -> asmitā -> vṛtti/karma -> vipāka -> nirodha.	ANALYSIS: "The doctrine is best read as a causal psychology of liberation."
FACT: Evaluate	FACT: Weighing strengths and weaknesses.	FACT: Give merits, limitations, and final graded assessment.	ANALYSIS: Use explicit grade: "philosophically strong in X, vulnerable in Y."
FACT: Compare	FACT: Similarities and differences across schools.	FACT: Use axes: self, God, causation, liberation, pramāṇa.	ANALYSIS: End with precise uniqueness of Yoga, not a generic similarity.
FACT: Distinguish	FACT: Sharp conceptual separation.	FACT: Table of axes; define both sides; add one trap line.	ANALYSIS: "Therefore A must not be reduced to B."
FACT: Elucidate	FACT: Clarifying a dense statement.	FACT: Translate the statement, identify terms, illustrate with citta/reflection examples.	ANALYSIS: "The statement means..., not..."
FACT: Comment	FACT: Thesis-focused evaluation in brief.	FACT: One clear stand, two doctrinal supports, one qualification.	ANALYSIS: End with a crisp judgement, not a long summary.
FACT: Bring out	FACT: Making implicit implications explicit.	FACT: Extract presuppositions, consequences and exam relevance.	ANALYSIS: "This brings out Yoga's deeper claim that..."
FACT: Do you agree?	FACT: Ability to take a qualified position.	FACT: State agreement level, support with doctrine, concede limitation.	ANALYSIS: "I agree insofar as..., but not if it means..."

11F. GRADED VERDICT ON YOGA

Philosophically strong FACT:

- FACT: Yoga gives a rigorous phenomenology of mental process: vṛtti, smṛti, nidrā, saṃskāra, kleśa and samādhi form a coherent psychology.
- FACT: It integrates psychology, ethics and metaphysics: yama-niyama, karma-vipāka and citta-nirodha are not separate compartments.
- FACT: It offers an operational path: abhyāsa, vairāgya, kriyā-yoga, aṣṭāṅga and samādhi supply a disciplined method rather than mere speculation.
- FACT: Its Kaivalya-pāda realist arguments show that Yoga is metaphysically committed, not merely a praxis manual.

Philosophically weak ANALYSIS:

- ANALYSIS: It inherits the puruṣa-prakṛti interaction problem: mere proximity explains much, but not all critics will accept it.

- ANALYSIS: Īśvara has limited explanatory role: he aids practice but is not creator, material cause or final giver of kaivalya.
- ANALYSIS: The value of contentless pure consciousness can be questioned by schools that define fulfilment through knowledge, relation, bliss or activity.

Genuinely contested CAUTION:

- CAUTION: The precise commentarial status of ānanda/asmitā as separate samāpattis or higher aspects of samprajñāta remains debated.
- CAUTION: Whether kaivalya should be described as blissful self-abidance or as austere isolation is interpreted differently by expositors.
- CAUTION: The historical unity and layering of the Yogasūtra tradition remain scholarly questions; do not build a UPSC answer on uncertain dating claims.

Ready verdicts.

- ANALYSIS: **10 marks:** "Yoga is best read as a disciplined psychology of citta-nirodha grounded in Sāṃkhya dualism and completed in kaivalya."
- ANALYSIS: **15 marks:** "Its strength lies in linking mental discipline, moral causation and liberation; its vulnerability lies in the unexplained proximity of inactive puruṣa and active prakṛti."
- ANALYSIS: **20 marks:** "Yoga is philosophically richer than a praxis manual: it offers a realist metaphysics, a subtle moral psychology and a graded meditative epistemology, though its dualism and limited Īśvara leave live objections for Advaita, Nyāya and Buddhist critics."

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced system assessment

Yoga's architecture is unusually integrated. Citta and vṛtti give phenomenology; klesa and karma give moral causation; āstanga supplies method; samādhi gives meditative epistemology; viveka and kaivalya complete liberation.

Its costs are inherited and added. The system must defend plural inactive witnesses, a continuing subtle mind, karmic deposits, extraordinary cognition and a special Puruṣa whose practical role exceeds his cosmological role.

Controlled Western comparisons may clarify suspension, witness-consciousness or habit, but must remain secondary. Husserlian reduction does not seek kaivalya, Cartesian consciousness acts, and psychoanalytic dispositions lack Yoga's rebirth framework.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

- "Analyse" requires the causal chain from avidyā to karma and release.
- "Critically examine" requires named objection, Yoga reply and remaining weakness.
- "Compare" should use pramāṇa, self, God, causation and liberation.
- Best overall criterion: operational explanatory power versus metaphysical verification and dualist interaction.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Strengths: phenomenology, ethical psychology, practical sequence, meditative analysis.
- Weaknesses: interaction, limited Isvara role, verification of extraordinary claims.
- Best verdict: philosophically richer than exercise, strongest as a disciplined psychology of liberation.

Progress: 8 / 8 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: PYQ Routing, Current Linkage and Complete Exam Deployment

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Plain-language visual - route the question first

QUESTION

|
+-- citta levels
+-- vrttis and nirodha
+-- klesas and kaivalya
+-- samadhi distinctions
+-- reflection and soteriology
+-- Isvara and liberation
|

definition -> mechanism -> distinction -> evaluation

In simple words: the seven verified questions cover nearly the entire syllabus. Prepare reusable doctrinal blocks and adapt them to marks and directive rather than memorising disconnected essays.

Marks	Minimum architecture
10	Exact definition -> list/stages -> mechanism
15	Doctrine -> soteriological role -> distinction -> verdict
20	Full causal chain -> therapy -> comparison -> criticism

Memory line: every Yoga answer must return to the release of Purusa from citta-identification.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

12. PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025)

ANALYSIS: Corpus signal: 7 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper I corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2019	Q7(b)	15 marks	How would Yoga philosophy comprehend the Citta-levels of a Scientist, a God-realized Devotee and a Self-realized Yogi? Justify your answer.
2020	Q5(b)	10 marks	Explain the difference between Samprajñāta Samādhi and Asamprajñāta Samādhi.
2021	Q6(a)	20 marks	Explain with reference to Yoga Philosophy, the nature of kleśas. How does the removal of these lead to kaivalya?
2022	Q5(c)	10 marks	Discuss the nature and different stages of Samādhi as per Pātañjala yoga and examine the role of Īśvara in it.
2023	Q7(c)	15 marks	Explain Citta and its modifications in the philosophy of Yoga. Why does Yoga philosophy prescribe cessation of modifications of Citta? Give reasons in support of your answer.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2024	Q7(b)	15 marks	"So long as there are changes and modifications in citta, the self is reflected therein, and, in the absence of discriminative knowledge, identifies itself with them." Present an appraisal of Yoga Soteriology in the light of the above statement.
2025	Q7(b)	15 marks	Explain the nature of God and its role in Kaivalya in yoga philosophy.

See the Indian Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2018–2025.

13. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

13.1 Ten-marker (10 marks)

Open with the exact doctrinal definition.
Name the canonical list/stages.
Give one causal or soteriological explanation.
Add one inter-school distinction or one trap-avoidance line.
Close by answering the directive directly.

Best use-cases: samādhi stages; citta-bhūmis; role of Īśvara; meaning of kaivalya.

13.2 Fifteen-marker (15 marks)

Frame the issue: Yoga as psychology of liberation within Sāṃkhya metaphysics.
Define the central term.
List and explain the canonical sub-types or stages.
Show why the doctrine matters for bondage/liberation.
Contrast with at least one rival school or one common confusion.
Conclude with one evaluative sentence.

Best use-cases: citta-vṛtti-nirodha; nature of God and role in kaivalya; citta and self-reflection.

13.3 Twenty-marker (20 marks)

Intro: locate Yoga as seśvara-sāṃkhya.
Exposition: define and classify the demanded concept fully.
Mechanism: show the causal chain from ignorance/kleśa to bondage.
Therapy: explain kriyā-yoga / aṣṭāṅga / samādhi / viveka-khyāti as needed.
Comparison: differentiate from Sāṃkhya, Advaita or Nyāya.
Critique and reply: add at least one live objection.
Conclusion: kaivalya as the school's final soteriological meaning.

Best use-case: kleśas and their removal leading to kaivalya.

13.4 Directive-word cues for Yoga answers

- ANALYSIS: The expanded directive decoder is now consolidated in §11E. **DIRECTIVE DECODER** immediately before the PYQ routing section.
- FACT: The original cues are preserved there and expanded into directive-specific structure, examiner demand and closing-verdict formulae.

14. LINK-OUTS

- Metaphysical base: Samkhya.md
- Comparative Vedānta contrasts: Vedanta.md
- Realist contrast on self, God and liberation: Nyaya-Vaisesika.md
- Cross-school self/liberation matrix: Self-and-liberation-across-schools.md
- Cross-school epistemology and Yoga's 3 pramāṇas: Pramana-across-schools.md
- Cross-paper God concepts: Notions-of-God.md
- Cross-paper mystical cognition / samādhi parallels: Religious-Experience.md
- Paper I house constitution: ../00_Master-Framework.md
- PYQ bank: ../PYQ-Indian-Philosophy-2018-2025.md

SOURCES

- Patañjali, *Yoga-sūtra*.
- Vyāsa, *Yoga-bhāṣya*.
- Vācaspati Miśra, *Tattvavaiśārādī*.
- Vijnānabhikṣu, *Yogavārttika*.
- S. Chatterjee and D. Datta, *An Introduction to Indian Philosophy*.
- C.D. Sharma, *A Critical Survey of Indian Philosophy*.
- S. Radhakrishnan, *Indian Philosophy*, Vol. II.

CURRENT LINKAGE - PUBLIC YOGA AND PHILOSOPHICAL YOGA

FACT: **Official contemporary anchor:** The Ministry of AYUSH's Yoga Mahotsav on **13 March 2026** began the countdown to International Day of Yoga and emphasized public-health protocols, daily practice and broad participation. This is useful as a contemporary opening, but it primarily concerns wellness promotion.

FACT: **Updated official anchor, 21 June 2026:** The 12th International Day of Yoga used the theme **Yoga for Healthy Ageing**, with the Ministry of Ayush as the nodal ministry. The theme supports a contemporary preventive-health opening, while remaining distinct from Patanjali's metaphysical and soteriological claims.

ANALYSIS: **Doctrine boundary:** Patanjala Yoga is not reducible to exercise or disease-management protocols. Its philosophical core is citta-vrtti-nirodha, removal of klesas, samadhi, viveka-khyati and kaivalya. Public-wellness initiatives illustrate social relevance; they do not establish metaphysical claims about Purusa, Prakriti or Isvara.

Direct local source anchors

- FACT: Chatterjee and Datta, local OCR edition, especially file pages 233-245: citta, five vrttis, citta-bhumis, samadhi, eight limbs and God.
- FACT: C. D. Sharma, local OCR edition, especially file pages 167-172: Patanjala definition, reflection, eight limbs and Isvara.
- FACT: The repository PYQ bank controls wording and marks for the seven solved questions.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Advanced current linkage and corpus strategy

The 2026 International Day of Yoga theme, **Yoga for Healthy Ageing**, and Ministry of Ayush public programmes provide a verified contemporary opening for preventive health and broad participation. They do not prove Patanjali's metaphysics or replace citta-vrtti-nirodha, klesa-removal, samadhi and kaivalya.

This doctrine boundary is exam-useful: public Yoga shows contemporary social relevance, while philosophical Yoga asks a different question—how disciplined transformation of citta ends misidentification and karmic bondage.

The corpus is modular. Master citta-bhumis, five vrttis, five klesas, eight limbs, samadhi distinctions, kaivalya and Isvara; then route each question to the correct block.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Exam route

The complete practice section contains:

- 7 verified solved PYQs from 2019-2025.
- 24 integrated MCQs and 8 remedial MCQs.
- Original 10-, 15- and 20-mark questions with model solutions.
- Final consolidated register notes after all teaching and practice.

Use current public-health Yoga only as a labelled contemporary anchor, never as doctrinal evidence.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall - master route

Prompt	Recall spine
Citta	material mind-complex reflecting Purusa
Vrtti	five forms; restraint through practice and detachment
Klesa	avidya-rooted causal colouring
Path	kriya-yoga and eight limbs
Samadhi	supported, beyond objectification, seedless
Isvara	special Purusa and contemplative aid
Kaivalya	discrimination, involution and self-abidance

PART II - SOLVED PYQs, PRACTICE AND ANSWER TRAINING

Solved PYQ 1 - 2019 Q7(b), 15 marks

Question: How would Yoga comprehend the citta-levels of a scientist, a God-realized devotee and a self-realized yogi?

Model solution

Yoga classifies citta into five bhumis: **ksipta** (restless), **mudha** (dull), **viksipta** (intermittently focused), **ekagra** (one-pointed), and **niruddha** (fully restrained).

Person	Citta-level	Justification
Scientist	viksipta	capable of sustained empirical focus, but attention remains outward and fluctuates beyond the chosen task
God-realized devotee	ekagra	mind is one-pointedly established in Isvara and fit for deep meditation
Self-realized yogi	niruddha	all vrttis are restrained and the seer abides in its own nature

The scientist should not automatically be called ekagra merely because of intellectual concentration. Yogic one-pointedness includes freedom from ordinary attachment and a stable inward orientation. The devotee's concentration is supported by Isvara-pranidhana. The self-realized yogi has crossed from concentration on an object to complete restraint.

Verdict: The hierarchy measures not intelligence but the degree of guna-purification and freedom from mental dispersion.

Why this earns marks: It applies all three cases precisely, avoids equating technical focus with yogic realization, and explains the governing criterion.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2020 Q5(b), 10 marks

Question: Distinguish Samprajnata Samadhi and Asamprajnata Samadhi.

Model solution

Samprajnata	Asamprajnata
cognitive absorption with an object	cessation beyond objectifying cognition
supported by prajna and a seed	only residual samskaras may remain
includes vitarka, vicara, ananda and asmita dimensions	reached through supreme dispassion and nirodha
yields truth-bearing insight at higher levels	prepares for nirbija when even seed is exhausted

Samprajnata is not ordinary thought. Citta becomes transparent and takes the object's form with extraordinary clarity. Its detailed samapatti distinctions—savitarka/nirvitarka and savicara/nirvicara—must not be confused mechanically with the fourfold Yoga Sutra 1.17 scheme.

Asamprajnata is not sleep or unconsciousness. Sleep is itself a vrtti supported by absence-cognition, whereas asamprajnata results from disciplined restraint and leaves a transformative nirodha-samskara.

Why this earns marks: It distinguishes object, seed, cognition and residual impressions and directly removes the common sleep-confusion.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2021 Q6(a), 20 marks

Question: Explain the nature of klesas and how their removal leads to kaivalya.

Model solution

Klesas are afflictive structures colouring cognition and generating karma. The five are:

1. **Avidya:** mistaking impermanent for permanent, impure for pure, painful for pleasurable and not-self for self.
2. **Asmita:** identification of seer with the seeing instrument.
3. **Raga:** attachment based on remembered pleasure.
4. **Dvesa:** aversion based on remembered pain.
5. **Abhinivesa:** deep clinging to life, present even in the learned.

Avidya is the field of the other four. Klesas may be prasupta, tanu, vicchinna or udara—dormant, attenuated, interrupted or fully active.

avidya -> asmita -> raga/dvesa -> action
-> karmasaya -> vipaka -> rebirth and suffering

Their removal is graded. **Kriya-yoga**—tapas, svadhyaya and Isvara-pranidhana—attenuates them. Eight-limbed discipline purifies conduct, body, breath, senses and attention. Dhyana burns subtle afflictions; discriminative knowledge destroys avidya's root. When klesas cease, fresh karmic deposits stop, old seeds are exhausted or burnt, and citta no longer produces identification.

Samadhi alone is instrumental unless it matures into **viveka-khyati**, uninterrupted discrimination between Purusa and citta. Para-vairagya prevents attachment even to insight and powers. Dharmamegha-samadhi completes the cessation of binding tendencies; the gunas undergo pratiprasava and Purusa stands in kaivalya.

An objection says Purusa was always free, so removal is unnecessary. Yoga replies that liberation removes misidentification in citta, not an actual impurity in Purusa.

Verdict: Klesa-removal leads to kaivalya by breaking both the cognitive root and karmic reproduction of bondage.

Why this earns marks: It defines all five, gives their states and causal chain, integrates kriya-yoga, astanga, samadhi and viveka, and answers the already-free objection.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2022 Q5(c), 10 marks

Question: Discuss stages of Samadhi and examine the role of Isvara.

Model solution

Patanjala Yoga broadly distinguishes **samprajnata** and **asamprajnata** samadhi. Samprajnata retains cognitive support and is associated with vitarka, vicara, ananda and asmita. The samapatti analysis further distinguishes gross and subtle absorptions with and without conceptual admixture. Nirvicara maturity yields **rtambhara prajna**, truth-bearing insight.

Asamprajnata suspends objectifying cognition while residual samskaras may remain. **Nirbija samadhi** occurs when even the seed sustaining further mental emergence is exhausted. Dharmamegha marks the culminating cloud of virtue and complete dispassion.

Isvara is **purusa-visesa**, eternally untouched by klesa, karma, fruition and latent deposits. Devotion to Isvara, repetition and contemplation of pranava, and surrender reduce obstacles and accelerate samadhi.

Verdict: Isvara is a privileged practical aid and timeless teacher, not the material cause or automatic giver of kaivalya; discriminative knowledge remains decisive.

Why this earns marks: It gives the stage architecture without conflating lists and evaluates Isvara's exact, limited function.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2023 Q7(c), 15 marks

Question: Explain citta and its modifications. Why prescribe cessation of cittavrttis?

Model solution

Citta is the material-subtle internal instrument comprising buddhi, ahamkara and manas. It reflects Purusa and assumes forms corresponding to objects. Its five vrttis are:

Vrtti	Meaning
Pramana	valid cognition
Viparyaya	error
Vikalpa	verbal construction without corresponding object
Nidra	sleep supported by cognition of absence
Smrti	retention and recollection

Each may be klista or aklista. Even valid cognition is a vrtti because it modifies citta and can sustain identification, though aklista cognition helps generate discrimination.

Yoga prescribes nirodha because the seer mistakes reflected mental states for itself. Modification creates samskara; samskara generates further vrtti and karmic continuity. Through abhyasa and vairagya this cycle is restrained:

vrtti -> identification -> klesa -> karma -> samskara -> further vrtti
nirodha -> viveka -> non-identification -> kaivalya

Nirodha is not destruction of mind or blankness. It is disciplined cessation allowing Purusa to abide in its own nature.

Verdict: Cessation is prescribed not because cognition is intrinsically evil, but because unrestrained modification obscures the distinction between seer and seen.

Why this earns marks: It defines citta, lists all vrttis, explains the samskara loop and gives a non-nihilistic account of nirodha.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2024 Q7(b), 15 marks

Question: Appraise Yoga soteriology in light of citta-reflection and self-identification.

Model solution

Yoga accepts the Samkhya dualism of inactive consciousness and active but unconscious citta. Citta is sattva-predominant and transparent; it reflects Purusa like a crystal reflecting a flower. It thereby appears conscious, while Purusa appears to know, act and suffer.

Bondage begins when **asmita** identifies drk-sakti, the seer's power, with darsana-sakti, the seeing instrument. Vrttis become appropriated as "I think," "I desire" and "I suffer." Klesas generate karma, deposits and rebirth.

Yoga's soteriology transforms the reflecting medium:

1. yama-niyama reduce moral disturbance;
2. asana-pranayama stabilize body and vitality;
3. pratyahara withdraws sensory dispersion;
4. dharana-dhyana-samadhi produce one-pointed transparency;
5. viveka-khyati permanently distinguishes Purusa from citta.

Kaivalya does not alter Purusa; it ends misattribution. The gunas cease functioning for that Purusa and return toward their causal ground.

The objection is that reflection presupposes a relation between ontologically separate principles. Mere proximity names rather than explains it. Yoga replies that all change occurs on the citta side; Purusa remains untouched.

Verdict: Yoga offers a coherent therapy of misidentification, though its reflection model inherits Samkhya's unresolved interaction problem.

Why this earns marks: It translates the quotation, traces the complete therapeutic sequence and gives the strongest metaphysical criticism.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2025 Q7(b), 15 marks

Question: Explain the nature of God and its role in Kaivalya in Yoga.

Model solution

Isvara is a **special Purusa** untouched by klesas, karma, karmic fruition and latent impressions. He is eternally free, omniscient in the unsurpassed sense and the timeless teacher of earlier teachers. Pranava is his verbal symbol.

Isvara is not Prakriti, not one liberated Purusa among others, and not straightforwardly the creator-God of Nyaya. Patanjali's primary interest is practical. **Isvara-pranidhana** weakens egoism, creates one-pointed devotion, removes obstacles and offers a direct aid to samadhi.

Kaivalya nevertheless consists in discriminative knowledge between Purusa and Prakriti. God does not absorb the individual, grant union with himself, or replace citta-nirodha. His role is privileged but instrumental:

Isvara-pranidhana -> reduced obstacles and ego
-> deeper samadhi -> viveka-khyati
-> cessation of guna-purpose -> kaivalya

Critics ask why Isvara is needed if the Samkhya ontology and viveka already suffice. Yoga may concede that other routes exist while insisting that devotion is uniquely efficient and that timeless teacherhood grounds the transmission of liberating knowledge.

Verdict: Isvara distinguishes Yoga from nirisvara Samkhya, but kaivalya remains isolation of Purusa through discrimination, not salvation by divine fusion.

Why this earns marks: It defines Isvara precisely, states positive and negative functions, connects devotion to kaivalya and evaluates the redundancy objection.

Integrated MCQ Loop - 24 Questions

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
1	Yoga is defined as: A. citta-vrtti-nirodha B. union with creator C. bodily fitness D. ritual action	A	Patanjali defines Yoga as restraint of mental modifications.
2	Citta includes: A. Purusa alone B. buddhi, ahamkara and manas C. gross body only D. five elements	B	It is the operative inner instrument.
3	The scientist in the PYQ is best placed at: A. mudha B. kshipta C. vikshipta D. niruddha	C	Strong but outward and intermittent focus remains vikshipta.
4	Complete restraint corresponds to: A. ekagra B. mudha C. vikshipta D. niruddha	D	Niruddha is fully restrained citta.
5	Root klesa is: A. avidya B. raga C. dvesa D. abhinivesa	A	Other afflictions grow in avidya's field.
6	Confusion of seer and seeing instrument is: A. smrti B. asmita C. nidra D. pramana	B	Asmita identifies Purusa with buddhi/citta.
7	Attachment based on pleasure is: A. abhinivesa B. avidya C. raga D. dvesa	C	Raga follows remembered pleasure.
8	Instinctive clinging to life is: A. asmita B. raga C. dvesa D. abhinivesa	D	It persists even in the learned.
9	Kriya-yoga consists of: A. tapas, svadhyaya, Isvara-pranidhana B. yama, niyama, asana C. dharana, dhyana, samadhi D. pramana, viparyaya, smrti	A	These attenuate klesas and prepare samadhi.
10	The fifth limb is: A. pranayama B. pratyahara C. dharana D. dhyana	B	Withdrawal follows breath regulation.
11	Continuous flow of attention is: A. asana B. dharana C. dhyana D. samyama	C	Dhyana is uninterrupted meditative flow.
12	Combined dharana-dhyana-samadhi is: A. nirodha B. viveka C. kriya-yoga D. samyama	D	Samyama is their integrated application.
13	Valid cognition is called: A. pramana-vrtti B. viparyaya C. vikalpa D. nidra	A	Even truth is a modification of citta.
14	Word-based construction without object is: A. smrti B. vikalpa C. pramana D. samadhi	B	Vikalpa arises from words lacking corresponding fact.
15	Sleep counts as vrtti because: A. it is samadhi B. Purusa sleeps C. absence-cognition leaves a recoltable impression D. all senses act	C	Later recollection indicates a supporting mental mode.
16	Samprajnata samadhi retains: A. no samskara whatsoever B. creator-consciousness C. bodily motion D. cognitive object/support	D	It is absorption with prajna and seed.
17	Truth-bearing insight is: A. rtambhara prajna B. asmita C. viveka only after death D. savitarka	A	It arises from mature nirvicara.
18	Isvara is: A. Prakriti B. purusa-visesa C. material creator D. liberated citta	B	He is eternally untouched special Purusa.
19	Isvara's verbal symbol is: A. Veda B. mahat C. pranava D. akasa	C	Om/pranava is contemplated with its meaning.
20	Kaivalya means: A. union with Brahman B. heavenly enjoyment C. merging into God D. isolation and self-establishment of Purusa	D	It is separation from guna-purpose.
21	Immediate liberating cognition is: A. viveka-khyati B. sensory perception C. testimony alone D. memory	A	Stable discrimination separates seer and seen.

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
22	Dharmamegha samadhi is linked with: A. attachment to powers B. supreme dispassion and final removal of affliction C. ordinary concentration D. sleep	B	It culminates the path when insight itself is not appropriated.
23	Yoga differs from Samkhya chiefly by: A. rejecting Purusa B. denying Prakriti C. adding disciplined praxis and Isvara D. accepting monism	C	It is often called sesvara-Samkhya.
24	Best doctrinal warning: A. Yoga is exercise only B. kaivalya is union C. Isvara creates matter D. public wellness Yoga must not replace Patanjala soteriology	D	Contemporary practice and classical doctrine must be distinguished.

Remedial MCQ Loop - 8 Questions

Q	Question and options	Key	Explanation
25	Ekagra means: A. one-pointed citta B. torpid citta C. fully seedless state D. error	A	It is Yoga-fit concentration but not complete restraint.
26	Which vrtti is recollection? A. nidra B. smrti C. vikalpa D. viparyaya	B	Smrti retains past experience.
27	Klesas in attenuated condition are: A. prasupta B. udara C. tanu D. vicchinna	C	Tanu means thinned through practice.
28	Asamprajnata is not sleep because it: A. contains ordinary dreams B. is caused by fatigue C. lacks discipline D. results from nirodha and transformative samskara	D	Its causal and soteriological structure differs from nidra.
29	First five limbs are generally: A. bahiranga B. antaranga C. samyama D. kaivalya	A	They are external aids relative to the final three.
30	Yoga's Isvara primarily functions as: A. material cause B. aid to concentration and timeless teacher C. karmic sufferer D. universal substance	B	Patanjali's emphasis is practical.
31	Reflection theory says: A. Purusa changes into citta B. citta is self-luminous C. citta appears conscious through Purusa's reflection D. both are identical	C	Citta borrows luminosity without changing Purusa.
32	Best overall verdict: A. Yoga is posture science B. samadhi alone automatically liberates C. God replaces discrimination D. Yoga integrates ethics and psychology, though dualist interaction remains contested	D	This captures its strength and central pressure.

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Why does Yoga count valid cognition among the vrttis to be restrained?

Model solution

Pramana presents objects truly, but it still modifies citta and can sustain identification: "I know." Yoga distinguishes epistemic truth from soteriological freedom. Valid cognition may be aklista and assist viveka, yet any object-form is still part of the seen.

The path therefore uses true cognition to remove error and finally relinquishes even the instrument when stable discrimination is achieved—like a thorn removing a thorn.

Verdict: Pramana is not condemned as false; it is transcended because kaivalya requires freedom from all citta-identification.

Why this earns marks: It resolves the apparent paradox and distinguishes truth-value from liberating finality.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 15 marks

Question: Is Astanga Yoga an ethical psychology rather than a sequence of exercises?

Model solution

The eight limbs form a causal architecture. Yama and niyama reduce interpersonal and intrapsychic disturbance. Asana stabilizes embodiment; pranayama regulates vitality and attention; pratyahara breaks sensory compulsion. Dharana, dhyana and samadhi progressively unify cognition.

The limbs therefore transform habits, affects, attention and identity. Without non-violence, truthfulness and non-grasping, concentration may strengthen ego and klesa rather than dissolve them. Without the inner limbs, ethics remains good conduct but does not mature into direct discrimination.

Verdict: Astanga is an ethical psychology completed in meditative epistemology; treating it as bodily exercise severs the very mechanism by which it leads to kaivalya.

Why this earns marks: It explains the functional relation among all limbs and states why ethical preparation is philosophically necessary.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 20 marks

Question: "Isvara is indispensable to Yoga practice but dispensable to Yoga metaphysics." Critically examine.

Model solution

Yoga's metaphysical framework largely follows Samkhya: Purusa, Prakriti, gunas, citta, karma and viveka explain bondage and liberation. Kaivalya occurs through discriminative knowledge, not union with or creation by God. This supports the claim of metaphysical dispensability.

Yet Isvara is more than ornament. As purusa-visesa he represents eternally unobstructed consciousness, grounds timeless teacherhood, supplies pranava as meditative support and makes surrender a powerful antidote to egoism. Patanjali explicitly presents Isvara-pranidhana as a route to samadhi.

The strongest instrumental reading says other means—abhyasa, vairagya and astanga—can also lead to realization, so Isvara is a uniquely efficient optional aid. A stronger theistic reading argues that transmission of liberating knowledge and coordination of Purusa-Prakriti require him; later commentators expand this role.

The redundancy objection remains: if Isvara neither creates Prakriti nor grants liberation, Yoga's distinct theism seems thin. The reply is that practical indispensability need not mean cosmological authorship. A perfect intentional object can reorganize citta without replacing its own effort and insight.

Verdict: The statement is broadly correct but too sharp. Isvara is not constitutive of the material ontology or formal definition of kaivalya, yet he is philosophically significant as exemplar, teacher and privileged technology of de-centering the ego.

Why this earns marks: It distinguishes metaphysical, epistemic and practical roles, presents competing readings and reaches a qualified verdict.

FINAL CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES - YOGA

System Spine

CITTA-VRTTI + KLESA

-> KARMA + SAMSKARA + REBIRTH

-> ABHYASA + VAIRAGYA + KRIYA/ASTANGA

-> SAMADHI + VIVEKA-KHYATI

-> PRATIPRASAVA

-> KAIVALYA

Citta

- Material-subtle inner instrument: buddhi, ahamkara, manas.
- Reflects Purusa and assumes object-forms.
- Five bhumis: kshipta, mudha, vikshipta, ekagra, niruddha.
- Ekagra and niruddha are Yoga-fit.

Five Vrttis

- Pramana: valid cognition.
- Viparyaya: error.
- Vikalpa: word-construction without object.
- Nidra: sleep based on absence-cognition.
- Smrti: recollection.
- Each can be klista or aklista.
- Nirodha is restraint, not unconscious destruction.

Five Klesas

- Avidya: root misapprehension.
- Asmita: seer-seen identification.
- Raga: attachment.
- Dvesa: aversion.
- Abhinivesa: clinging to life.
- States: prasupta, tanu, vicchinna, udara.

Eight Limbs

YAMA -> NIYAMA -> ASANA -> PRANAYAMA
-> PRATYAHARA -> DHARANA -> DHYANA -> SAMADHI

- Yama: ahimsa, satya, asteya, brahmacharya, aparigraha.
- Niyama: saucha, santosa, tapas, svadhyaya, Ishvara-pranidhana.
- Final three combine as samyama.

Samadhi

- Samprajnata: object-supported cognitive absorption.
- Fourfold character: vitarka, vicara, ananda, asmita.
- Samapattis: savitarka/nirvitarka; savicara/nirvicara.
- Rtam bhara prajna: truth-bearing insight.
- Asamprajnata: beyond cognitive objectification, residual seed may remain.
- Nirbija: even seed ceases.
- Dharmamegha: supreme dispassion and final transition.

Ishvara

- Purusa-visesa untouched by klesa, karma, vipaka and asaya.
- Omniscient and timeless teacher.
- Pranava is symbol.
- Removes obstacles and accelerates samadhi.
- Not straightforward Nyaya creator or Vedantic absolute.
- Does not replace viveka-khyati.

Kaivalya

- Isolation/self-establishment of Purusa.
- Citta completes its purpose; gunas undergo pratiprasava.
- Purusa was never intrinsically modified.
- Not union with Brahman or God.
- Not blank unconsciousness.

PYQ Route Map

- 2019: scientist, devotee and yogi citta-levels.
- 2020: samprajnata versus asamprajnata.
- 2021: klesas and kaivalya.
- 2022: samadhi stages and Isvara.
- 2023: citta, vrttis and nirodha.
- 2024: reflection and Yoga soteriology.
- 2025: God and kaivalya.

Final Traps

1. Yoga is not merely asana.
2. Citta is not Purusa.
3. Ekagra is not identical with niruddha.
4. Pramana can be true yet remain a vrtti.
5. Nidra is a vrtti; asamprajnata is not sleep.
6. Samprajnata's fourfold list is not identical to samapatti subtypes.
7. Isvara is purusa-visesa, not material cause.
8. Samadhi supports liberation; viveka-khyati is decisive.
9. Kaivalya is isolation, not divine union.
10. Public-health Yoga is contemporary linkage, not a substitute for Patanjala doctrine.